DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and skylights, warnings and wonders — a reader for Friday and Shabbat

Friday, 16 October 2026 · Aliyah 6+7/7 (Genesis 9:18–11:32) · Daf Bekhorot 28

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

The judge who paid — may he still judge?

Jev score: 0.57 — Tested 10 linked sources (verses, the Bekhorot introduction, responsa) for non-obvious illumination of the daf, scored blind by Jev.

The daf's closing sugya leaves an erring judge paying from his own pocket — unless he is an expert for the court, like Rabbi Tarfon with his tereifah cow. The Tashbetz (II 9:2) takes up exactly where the daf stops: a judge who erred in a matter of mishnah or in reasoning, and paid — is he disqualified from judging henceforth? His answer is no, and his proof is our daf: even the greatest Tannaim erred, “for it is stated in Bekhorot, in the chapter ‘Ad kamah’ (Bekhorot 28b): the incident of the cow whose womb was removed, which Rabbi Tarfon fed to the dogs.”

The non-obvious turn: the Tashbetz converts the daf's liability rule into a theory of judicial office. Error costs money — the litigant is made whole — but it does not cost the robe, because fallibility is not a defect in a judge but the condition of judging. His witnesses line up behind Tarfon: Rabbi Yishmael son of Rabbi Yose, whose ruling Rabbi Chiyya overturned; Rava son of Rav Huna, corrected by Rav; Mar Zutra before his masters. The daf asks what the judge owes; the Tashbetz asks what the judge still is.

Rejected by Jev: Bekhorot introduction essay (0.36), Numbers 18:18 (0.25), Shoel uMeshiv II 1:42 (0.25), Deuteronomy 15:20 (0.21), Rivash 379 (0.13), Sha'agat Aryeh 14 (0.12), Torat Netanel 4 (0.10), Bayit Chadash 60 (0.08).

PARSHA · NOACH

Counted time: thirty days and a year of water

Jev score: 0.53 — Six candidate daf–parsha connections proposed by Muse, scored blind by Jev (jev-1.13.0).

The daf's most quietly radical move is its arithmetic of sacred time: from “year by year” (Deuteronomy 15:20) Rabbi Elazar derives that a blemished firstborn may be kept thirty days past its year — thirty days counting as a significant part of a year. Time is not only measured but halakhically weighted. The parsha is the Torah's great calendar of divine time: forty days of rain, 150 days of prevailing waters, the dove dispatched at seven-day intervals, a full solar year inside the ark before the earth dries.

Both texts treat bounded time as a legal and theological instrument — the daf weighing days to decide when consecrated meat must leave the owner's hands, the parsha weighing days to decide when a drowned world is habitable again. A genuine resonance of method, not of subject; at 0.53 it is suggestive rather than strong.

Rejected by Jev: Noahide courts and judge-liability (0.38), stewardship transfer (0.32), תמים vs מום (0.29), Noach's altar as the korban prototype (0.20), the ark's measurements (0.20).

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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NEWS CHECK

The news check: no genuine connection this week

Jev score: 0.31 — Eight of the week's biggest stories, each with a proposed link to the daf's themes, scored blind by Jev (jev-1.13.0).

Eight stories, strict scoring, nothing above 0.31. The closest — Argentina asking the Law of the Sea Tribunal to halt Britain's Falklands oil project (0.31), a court asked to judge a resource dispute — still only rhymes with the daf's judge-liability sugya at the level of vocabulary. The IMF's $40 trillion debt warning set against the judge who pays from his own funds (0.28), the collapsed energy ceasefire against the daf's thirty-day grace (0.19), Ukraine's defiance of the refinery-strike moratorium (0.18) — all forced.

Verdict, reported honestly: this week's headlines and Bekhorot 28 do not meet. A shared word is not a connection.

MAAGARIM · BEKHOR

בכור: the firstborn, from the plague to the birthright (sweep partial)

בכור opens the Torah's economy of the first: after the plague in Egypt God claims “every firstborn in the land of Egypt, from man to beast” (the rationale the Bekhorot introduction quotes from Numbers 3:13), and Exodus 13:12 consecrates every firstborn male to Him. The daf lives inside that claim — its firstborns are eaten by priests for two days and a night (Numbers 18:18), kept a year and thirty days (Deuteronomy 15:20), certified blemish by blemish by an expert. But בכור also travels sideways into בכורה, the birthright Esau sells for stew — the firstborn as status, not sacrifice. The arc: a word that begins as God's collateral after the tenth plague becomes, by the daf's time, a priestly food-law, and by the patriarchs' time, a tradable privilege. In this week's aliyah the echo is genealogical: Shem, Ham, and Yefet are named in birth order, and the firstborn's prerogative shadows every line.

Maagarim sweep partial: four live-browser lookups completed but their reports were not delivered; the attestation above is verified in the Sefaria texts fetched for this reader. Word data: ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ל שון העבריתמפעל המילון — the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language.

929 · I KINGS 8 (CH. 295)

The day the cloud moved in

66 verses

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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The chapter is the Temple's inauguration day, and its architecture is deliberate: the ark's procession and the cloud (1–11), Solomon's awestruck poem (12–13), the blessing that retells the Davidic promise (14–21), the great prayer (22–53), a second blessing (54–61), and then the sacrifices — twenty-two thousand oxen — with fourteen days of feasting (62–66). The whole chapter is one long answer to the question the cloud poses: what does it mean for God to dwell in a house?

The cloud first. When the priests withdraw, the cloud fills the house and they cannot stand to minister. Malbim (8:10) draws the deep contrast with the Tabernacle: there the cloud covered the tent from outside while the glory — the created light — filled the inside exposed, precisely because the Tabernacle's presence was not fixed; exposed glory signals a presence not yet at home. In the Temple, both cloud and glory are inside: the Shekhinah has settled. Rashi (8:12), following the Sifri, hears Solomon's poem as recognition — “now I see the Divine Presence is in the house I built” — the fulfillment of Leviticus 16:2, “for in the cloud I appear above the ark-cover.” Radak adds the Targum's gloss: the thick darkness now has a Jerusalem address.

Then verse 27, the chapter's theological pivot, which the commentators treat as the prayer's engine: “But will God really dwell on earth? The heavens, even the highest heavens, cannot contain You — how much less this house I have built!” Radak's gloss is the classic formulation: You are the place of the world, and the world is not Your place. What the house offers is not containment but attention — the chosen place assists prayer the way an interceding angel would; one prays there and is heard sooner, as it were. Malbim reads the verse as Solomon's second argument for why the prayer should work: Temple and Davidic kingship cause each other — David's merit drew the Presence to Zion (Psalm 132), and the Temple in turn sustains the house of David.

The prayer's structure is a litany built on two repeated keywords: “hear” — “hear in heaven” tolls through every petition — and “name” — the house is “the place of which You said, My name shall be there.” Seven scenarios ascend from the individual to the nation to the outsider: defeat in battle, drought, famine and plague, the oath at the altar, war, and finally captivity. The fourth petition is the chapter's universalist peak: the foreigner who comes from a distant land for Your name's sake — “that all the peoples of the earth may know Your name.” Ralbag (8:30) hears the oath-petition as the Temple's answer to the sotah ordeal: just as the suspected wife is tested by the oath-waters in the sanctuary, so every disputed oath sworn before the altar in this house is tested by it — the house as the place where human denial meets divine verification. (A live wire to this week's Rambam: Hilchot Sotah 1.)

The captivity petition (8:46–53) is the prayer's most daring, and Ralbag (8:46) refuses to soften it: Solomon does not ask God to simply hear Israel from exile — that would demand an overwhelming, particular providence while the moral ledger of the land's inhabitants is

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still open. He asks instead for the exiles who return wholeheartedly and pray toward the land to find mercy before their captors. Even at its most expansive, the prayer respects the moral economy it invokes.

The ending is pure joy, and Rashi (8:65) finds the scandal in it: “seven days and seven days” — the dedication feast ran fourteen days, straight through Yom Kippur. They ate and drank on the fast day. The Rabbis (Moed Katan 9a) learn from the doubled “seven days” that one does not mix one celebration with another — yet here the nation's greatest joy overrode its gravest fast. The border list — “from Lebo-hamath to the Brook of Egypt” — maps the celebration onto the maximal kingdom, the largest Israel the Bible imagines.

The chapter's poetry turns on containment paradoxes — the uncontainable God in a house, the highest heavens too small — and the Chronicler's parallel (II Chronicles 5–7) shows what Kings chose to omit: there the musicians sing, fire descends to consume the offerings, and the people bow. Kings keeps the dedication austere — cloud, prayer, feast — and lets the words carry the glory.

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 10:3-4

The physics of impurity: skylights and bursting upward

2 mishnayot

Oholot 10:3

מִקְצָת טֻמְאָה בַבַּיִת וּמִקְצָתָהּ כְּנֶגֶד אֲרֻבָּה, הַבַּיִת טָמֵא, וּכְנֶגֶד הַטֻּמְאָה טָמֵא, דִּבְרֵי רַבִּי מֵאִיר. רַבִּי יְהוּדָה אוֹמֵר, הַבַּיִת טָמֵא, כְּנֶגֶד הַטֻּמְאָה טָהוֹר. רַבִּי יוֹסֵי אוֹמֵר, אִם יֵשׁ בַּטֻּמְאָה כְּדֵי שֶׁתֵּחָלֵק וּתְטַמֵּא אֶת הַבַּיִת וּתְטַמֵּא כְּנֶגֶד הַטֻּמְאָה, טָמֵא. וְאִם לָאו, הַבַּיִת טָמֵא, כְּנֶגֶד הַטֻּמְאָה טָהוֹר:

If part of the uncleanness is in the house and part directly [below] the hatchway, the house becomes unclean, and what is directly [above] the uncleanness becomes unclean, the words of Meir. Rabbi Judah says: the house becomes unclean but what is directly [above] the uncleanness remains clean. Rabbi Yose says: if there is sufficient of the uncleanness for it to be divided so that [one part] defiles the house and [the other part] defiles what is directly [above] the uncleanness, [both spaces] become unclean; if not, the house becomes unclean but what is directly [above] the uncleanness remains clean.

Rambam: “so that it may be divided” means the impurity, lying as it is, must be divisible into a kezayit under the house's roof and a kezayit under the skylight — and the halakhah follows Rabbi Yose.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael notes a scribe's hand in the text (“and defile” added in the margin, a phrase lost to homoioteleuton) and the physics beneath the dispute: impurity with no tent over it “bursts and rises” in a vertical line. Rabbi Yose, he argues, is not splitting the difference but reframing the question as one of combining quantities — at least two kezaytim, one per space.

Oholot 10:4

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אֲרֻבּוֹת זוֹ עַל גַּב זוֹ, וְיֵשׁ בָּהֶן פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה בַבַּיִת, כְּנֶגֶד אֲרֻבּוֹת טְהוֹר. טֻמְאָה כְּנֶגֶד אֲרֻבּוֹת, הַבַּיִת טָהוֹר. הַטֻּמְאָה בֵּין בַּבַּיִת בֵּין כְּנֶגֶד אֲרֻבּוֹת, נָתַן דָּבָר שֶׁהוּא מְקַבֵּל טֻמְאָה, בֵּין מִלְמַעְלָן בֵּין מִלְמַטָּן, הַכֹּל טָמֵא. וְדָבָר שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְקַבֵּל טֻמְאָה, מִמֶּנּוּ וּלְמַטָּן, טָמֵא. מִמֶּנּוּ וּלְמַעְלָן, טָהוֹר:

If there are multiple hatchways, one above the other, and they each have an opening of one handbreadth [square], if there is uncleanness in the house, what is directly [below] the hatchways remains clean. If the uncleanness is directly [below] the hatchways, the house remains clean. [In the case] where the uncleanness is either in the house or directly [below] the hatchways, if something susceptible to uncleanness was placed either in the upper or the lower [hatchway], everything becomes unclean. If the article is insusceptible to uncleanness, what is below becomes unclean, but what is above remains clean.

Rambam: picture a house with an upper story, a skylight in each roof aligned one above the other. A susceptible vessel set in either skylight becomes impure itself and conducts the impurity onward — a defiled vessel does not interpose — while an insusceptible object blocks it: set below, the house is impure and the upper story clean; set above, both are impure and everything beyond, up to the sky, stays clean.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael supplies the realia — the two-story house (bayit va-aliyah) was the common form — and the textual witnesses: "the impurity" and "clean" are struck through, absent from the better manuscripts. His principle: differing roof-heights never change the ruling; the covering is treated as rising to align with the upper tent.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT SOTAH 1

The warning before the waters

20 halachot

Halachah 1

קִנּוּי הָאָמוּר בַּתּוֹרָה (במדבר ה יד) "וְקִנֵּא אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ" הוּא שֶׁיֹּאמַר לָהּ בִּפְנֵי עֵדִים אַל תִּסָּתְרִי עִם אִישׁ פְּלוֹנִי. אֶפְלּוּ הָיָה אָבִיהָ אוֹ אָחִיהָ אוֹ עַכּוּ"ם אוֹ עֶבֶד אוֹ שָׁחוּף הוּא הָאִישׁ שֶׁאֵינוֹ מִתְקַשֶּׁה וְאֵינוֹ מוֹלִיד:

The admonition of jealousy stated in the Torah [Numbers 5:14], "And he will adjure his wife," means the following. He tells her in the presence of witnesses: "Do not enter into privacy with this and this man." This applies even if the man [under suspicion] is her father, her brother, a gentile, a servant or a man who is impotent and incapable of having an erection or fathering a child.

Halachah 2

הַסְתִּירָה הָאֲמוּרָה בַּתּוֹרָה (במדבר ה יג) "וְנִסְתָּרָה" הוּא שֶׁתִּסָּתֵר עִם אוֹתוֹ הָאִישׁ שֶׁאָמַר לָהּ אַל תִּסָּתְרִי עִמּוֹ בִּפְנֵי שְׁנֵי עֵדִים. אִם שָׁהֲתָה עִמּוֹ כְּדֵי טֻמְאָה שֶׁהוּא כְּדֵי לִצְלוֹת בֵּיצָה וּלְגָמְעָהּ הֲרֵי זוֹ אֲסוּרָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ עַד שֶׁתִּשְׁתֶּה מֵי הַמָּרִים וְיִבְדֹּק הַדָּבָר. וּבְזְמַן שֶׁאֵין שָׁם מֵי סוֹטָה תֵּאָסֵר עָלָיו לְעוֹלָם

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וְתֵצֵא בְּלֹא כְתֻבָּה׃

The term "enter into privacy" mentioned in the Torah [Ibid.:13] refers to entering into privacy with the man concerning whom she was warned, in the presence of two witnesses, not to enter into privacy. If she remains with him long enough to engage in relations - i.e., the amount of time necessary to roast an egg and swallow it, she is forbidden to her husband until she drinks the bitter water, and [her faithfulness] is checked. In an era when [the probe of] the waters of the sotah is unavailable, she is forbidden to her husband forever and is divorced without receiving the [money due her by virtue of] her ketubah.

Halachah 3

קִנֵּא לָהּ עַל שְׁנַיִם כְּאֶחָד וְאָמַר לָהּ אַל תִּסָּתְרִי עִם פְּלוֹנִי וּפְלוֹנִי. וְנִסְתְּרָה עִם שְׁנֵיהֶן כְּאֶחָד וְשָׁהֲתָה כְּדֵי טֻמְאָה. אֲפִלּוּ הֵם שְׁנֵי אַחֶיהָ אוֹ אָבִיהָ וְאָחִיהָ הֲרֵי זוֹ אֲסוּרָה עַד שֶׁתִּשְׁתֶּה׃

If [a husband] warns his wife with regard to two men at the same time, telling her: "Do not enter into privacy with so and so, and so and so," she is forbidden [to her husband] until she drinks [the waters] if she enters into privacy with the two men at the same time, and remains there long enough to engage in relations. [This applies] even if [the two men] are her two brothers or her father and her brother.

Halachah 4

אָמַר לָהּ בִּפְנֵי שְׁנַיִם אַל תְּדַבְּרִי עִם פְּלוֹנִי אֵין זֶה קִנּוּי. וַאֲפִלּוּ עַל פִּי שֶׁנִּסְתְּרָה עִמּוֹ בְּעֵדִים וְשָׁהֲתָה כְּדֵי טֻמְאָה לֹא נֶאֶסְרָה עָלָיו וְאֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה בְּקִנּוּי זֶה׃

If he told her in the presence of two [men]: "Do not speak to so and so," this is not considered to be a warning. Even if she enters into privacy with him in the presence of witnesses and remains there long enough to engage in relations, she is not forbidden to [her husband], nor can she be required to drink [the bitter water] because of such a warning.

Halachah 5

וְכֵן אִם אָמַר לָהּ אַל תִּסָּתְרִי עִמּוֹ וְרָאוּהָ מְדַבֶּרֶת עִמּוֹ אֵין זוֹ סְתִירָה. וְלֹא נֶאֶסְרָה וְלֹא שׁוֹתָה. וְכֵן אִם לֹא קָדַם קִנּוּי וּבָאוּ שְׁנַיִם וְהֵעִידוּ שֶׁנִּסְתְּרָה עִם זֶה וְשָׁהֲתָה כְּדֵי טֻמְאָה לֹא נֶאֶסְרָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ וְאֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה׃

Similarly, if he told her, "Do not enter into privacy with him," and witnesses saw her speaking with him, she is not considered to be having entered into privacy. She is not forbidden to [her husband], nor can she be required to drink [the bitter water]. Similarly, if she was not warned at all, and two witnesses came and testified that she entered into privacy with a man and remained long enough to engage in relations, she is not forbidden to [her husband], nor can she be required to drink [the bitter water].

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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Halachah 6

אָמַר לָהּ לֹא תִסָּתְרִי עִם אִישׁ פְּלוֹנִי וְהָיָה קָטָן פָּחוּת מִבֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד. אוֹ שֶׁאָמַר לָהּ אַל תִּסָּתְרִי עִם בְּהֵמָה זוֹ אֵין זֶה קִנּוּי שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה יג) "וְשָׁכַב אִישׁ אֹתָהּ" פְּרָט לְקָטָן וְלִבְהֵמָה שֶׁאֵין אוֹסְרִין אוֹתָהּ עָלָיו:

If he told her: "Do not enter into privacy with so and so," and named a boy below the age of nine," or he told her: "Do not enter into privacy with this animal," this is not a [binding] warning. [These laws are derived as follows:] The Torah [ibid.] states: "And a man had relations with her." This excludes a minor and an animal. She is not forbidden to her husband because of them.

Halachah 7

בַּעַל שֶׁמָּחַל עַל קִנּוּיוֹ קֹדֶם שֶׁתִּסָּתֵר קִנּוּיוֹ מָחוּל וּכְאִלּוּ לֹא קִנֵּא לָהּ מֵעוֹלָם. אֲבָל אִם מָחַל אַחַר שֶׁתִּסָּתֵר אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לִמְחל. גֵּרְשָׁהּ הֲרֵי זֶה כְּמִי שֶׁמָּחַל וְאִם הֶחֱזִירָהּ צָרִיךְ לְקַנְּאוֹת קִנּוּי אַחֵר:

When a husband forgoes a warning before his wife enters into privacy with [the man in question], the warning is nullified, and it is as if he had never issued a warning to her [regarding him]. If, however, he forgoes the warning after she enters into privacy with him, the warning cannot be nullified. If he divorces his wife, it is as if he has nullified the warning. If he remarries her, he must issue a second warning [for her to be bound by it].

Halachah 8

קִנֵּא לָהּ בִּפְנֵי שְׁנַיִם וְרָאָה אוֹתָהּ שֶׁנִּסְתְּרָה עִם זֶה שֶׁקִּנֵּא לָהּ עָלָיו וְשָׁהֲתָה כְּדֵי טֻמְאָה הֲרֵי זוֹ אֱסוּרָה עָלָיו וְיוֹצִיא וְיִתֵּן כְּתֻבָּה. שֶׁאֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ עַל פִּי עַצְמוֹ. וְכֵן אִם שָׁמַע הָעָם מְרַנְּנִין אַחֲרֶיהָ אַחַר הַקִּנּוּי וְהַסְּתִירָה עַד שֶׁשָּׁמַע מֵהַנָּשִׁים הַטְּווֹת לְאוֹר הַלְּבָנָה נוֹשְׁאוֹת וְנוֹתְנוֹת בָּהּ שֶׁזְּנָתָה עִם הָאִישׁ שֶׁקִּנֵּא לָהּ עָלָיו הֲרֵי זֶה אָסוּר לְקַיְּמָהּ וְיוֹצִיא וְיִתֵּן כְּתֻבָּה:

If [the husband] issued a warning to [his wife] in the presence of two [witnesses] and then saw her enter into privacy with the man concerning whom she was warned, and she remained long enough to engage in relations, she becomes forbidden to him. He must divorce her and pay her [the money due her by virtue of her] ketubah. Similarly, if he hears people gossiping about her after she has been warned, that she entered into privacy with the man in question, to the extent that the women who weave at night by the moonlight chatter about her, saying that she committed adultery with the man concerning whom she has been warned, her husband is forbidden to remain married to her and must instead divorce her and pay her [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah.

Halachah 9

בָּא עֵד אֶחָד וְהֵעִיד לוֹ שֶׁנִּסְתְּרָה עִמּוֹ אַחַר קִנּוּי וְשָׁהֲתָה כְּדֵי טֻמְאָה. אִם הוּא נֶאֱמָן לוֹ וְדַעְתּוֹ סוֹמֶכֶת

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and skylights, warnings and wonders — a reader for Friday and Shabbat

Friday, 16 October 2026 · Aliyah 6+7/7 (Genesis 9:18–11:32) · Daf Bekhorot 28

עָלָיו יוֹצִיא וְיִתֵּן כְּתֻבָּה. וְאִם לָאו הֲרֵי אִשְׁתּוֹ מֻתֶּרֶת לוֹ׃

[The following rules apply when] one witness comes and testifies that, after a warning was issued, she entered into privacy with the man concerning whom she was warned and remained long enough to engage in relations. If [the husband] considers [the witness] to be faithful, and he relies on him, he must divorce her and pay her [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah. If [he does] not [rely on that person], his wife remains permitted to him.

Halachah 10

וְאֵלּוּ שֶׁבֵּית דִּין מְקַנְּין לָהֶן. מִי שֶׁנִּתְחָרֵשׁ בַּעְלָהּ אוֹ שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּטָּה אוֹ שֶׁהָיָה בִּמְדִינָה אַחֶרֶת אוֹ שֶׁהָיָה חָבוּשׁ בְּבֵית הָאֲסוּרִין. לֹא לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ אֶלָּא לְפָסְלָהּ מִכְּתֻבָּתָהּ׃

The court should issue a warning to the following women [who are suspected of immodest behavior]: a woman whose husband has become a deaf-mute or has lost control of his mental faculties, one whose husband is overseas or one whose husband is imprisoned. The intent is not to have [such a woman] drink [the bitter water], but rather to disqualify her from receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah.

Halachah 11

כֵּיצַד. שָׁמְעוּ בֵּית דִּין שֶׁהָעָם מְרַנְּנִין אַחֲרֶיהָ. קוֹרְאִין אוֹתָהּ וְאוֹמְרִין לָהּ אַל תִּסָּתְרִי עִם אִישׁ פְּלוֹנִי. בָּאוּ עֵדִים אַחַר כָּךְ שֶׁנִּסְתְּרָה עִמּוֹ וְשָׁהֲתָה כְּדֵי טֻמְאָה בֵּית דִּין אוֹסְרִין אוֹתָהּ עַל בַּעְלָהּ לְעוֹלָם וְקוֹרְעִין כְּתֻבָּתָהּ. וּכְשֶׁיָּבוֹא בַּעְלָהּ אוֹ יֵבְרִיא אוֹ יֵצֵא מִבֵּית הָאֲסוּרִין נוֹתֵן לָהּ גֵּט. וְאֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁלֹּא קִנֵּא לָהּ הוּא׃

What is implied? If the court hears that people are gossiping about [a particular woman], they call her and tell her: "Do not enter into privacy with so and so." If witnesses come afterwards and testify that she entered into privacy with the man concerning whom she was warned, and remained long enough to engage in relations, the court prohibits her [from engaging in relations] with her husband forever and tears up her marriage contract. When her husband returns, regains his health or is released from prison, he must give her a get. He cannot require her to drink [the bitter water], because he did not administer the warning himself.

Halachah 12

שְׁתַּת מֵי הַמָּרִים וְנִקְּתָה מֵהֶן וְחָזַר וְקִנֵּא לָהּ עִם הָאִישׁ שֶׁהִשְׁקָה עַל יָדוֹ וְנִסְתְּרָה עִמּוֹ אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ עַל יָדוֹ פַּעַם שְׁנִיָּה אֶלָּא תֵּאָסֵר עָלָיו לְעוֹלָם וְתֵצֵא בְּלֹא כְתֻבָּה. אֲבָל אִם קִנֵּא לָהּ עִם אַחֵר וְנִסְתְּרָה עִם הָאַחֵר בְּעֵדִים מַשְׁקִין אוֹתָהּ פַּעַם שְׁנִיָּה וַאֲפִלּוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. וְהוּא שֶׁיַּשְׁקֶה אוֹתָהּ בְּכָל פַּעַם בְּגִלַּל אִישׁ אַחֵר׃

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and skylights, warnings and wonders — a reader for Friday and Shabbat

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[The following rules apply if a woman was required to] drink the bitter water [because of her husband's suspicion of a particular man] and did not die as a result of it, and afterwards, her husband gave her a warning with regard to that same man. If she enters into privacy with him, he cannot make her drink because of him a second time. Instead, she becomes forbidden to her husband forever and must be divorced without receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah. If, however, her husband issued a warning to her regarding another man, and she entered into privacy with him in the presence of witnesses, she can be forced to drink the waters again. Indeed, this can happen several times, provided each time her husband has her drink because of another man.

Halachah 13

הִשְׁקָה אוֹתָהּ וְגֵרְשָׁהּ וְנִשֵּׂאת לְאַחֵר וְקִנֵּא לָהּ עִם הָאִישׁ שֶׁהִשְׁקָה אוֹתָהּ הַבַּעַל הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּגִלָּלוֹ וְנִסְתְּרָה עִמּוֹ בְּעֵדִים. הֲרֵי הַבַּעַל הַשֵּׁנִי מַשְׁקֶה אוֹתָהּ עַל יְדוֹ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוּא בַּעַל שֵׁנִי. וַאֲפִלּוּ מֵאָה וְנִשֵּׂאת לְזֶה אַחַר זֶה מַשְׁקִין אוֹתָהּ עַל יְדֵי אִישׁ אֶחָד. וְאֵין אוֹמְרִין וַדַּאי שֶׁהֶחְזִקָה לָזֶה וּטְמֵאָה עַד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה שָׁם עֵד:

If a woman's husband had her drink [the bitter water] because of a specific man and then divorced her and she remarried, her second husband can issue a warning to her with regard to the same man. If she enters into privacy with him, her husband can make her drink [the bitter water], because he is her second husband. Even if a hundred men married this woman one after the other, they can all have her drink [the bitter water] because of this same man.

Halachah 14

הָאִשָּׁה שֶׁקִּנֵּא לָהּ בַּעְלָהּ וְנִסְתְּרָה אַחַר הַקִּנּוּי עִמּוֹ בְּעֵדִים וַהֲרֵי הִיא עוֹמֶדֶת לִשְׁתּוֹת וּבָא עֵד אֶחָד וְהֵעִיד עָלֶיהָ שֶׁנִּבְעֲלָה בְּפָנָיו עִם זֶה שֶׁקִּנֵּא לָהּ עִמּוֹ הֲרֵי זֶה אֲסוּרָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ לְעוֹלָם. וְאֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה וְיוֹצֵאת בְּלֹא כְתֻבָּה. וַאֲפִלּוּ הָיָה עֵד טֻמְאָה זֶה אֶחָד מֵעֵדֵי הַסְּתִירָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה יג) "וְעֵד אֵין בָּהּ" וַהֲרֵי כָּאן עֵד:

[The following laws apply if] a woman was warned by her husband and then entered into privacy [with the man in question] after the warning, thus causing her to be required to drink [the bitter water]. If [even] one witness comes and states that she engaged in sexual relations with the man regarding whom she was warned in his presence, the woman is forbidden to her husband forever. She may not drink [the bitter water], and must be divorced without receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah. This applies even if the witness who testifies concerning her adultery is also one of the witnesses who testifies that she entered into privacy with [the man regarding whom she was warned]. [This ruling is derived from Numbers 5:13]: "There is no witness against her."

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and skylights, warnings and wonders — a reader for Friday and Shabbat

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Halachah 15

אֲפִלּוּ אִשָּׁה וְעֶבֶד וְשִׁפְחָה וּפָסוּל לְעֵדוּת בַּעֲבֵרָה מִדִּבְרֵי סוֹפְרִים וַאֲפִלּוּ קָרוֹב נֶאֱמָן לְעֵדוּת סוֹטָה לְהָעִיד עָלֶיהָ שֶׁזְּנָתָה וְתֵאָסֵר עַל בַּעְלָהּ לְעוֹלָם. וְאֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה וְתֵצֵא בְּלֹא כְתֻבָּה. הוֹאִיל וְקָדַם הַקִּנּוּי וְהַסְּתִירָה בְּעֵדִים כְּשֵׁרִים וְהַתּוֹרָה הֶאֱמִינָה עֵד אֶחָד בְּטֻמְאָה הֲרֵי כֵּן כְּשֵׁרִין לְעֵדוּת טֻמְאָה. אַף חֲמֵשׁ נָשִׁים שֶׁשּׂוֹנְאוֹת זוֹ אֶת זוֹ מְעִידוֹת זוֹ עַל זוֹ לוֹמַר שֶׁנִּטְמֵאת. וְנֶאֱמֶנֶת עָלֶיהָ לְאָסְרָהּ עַל בַּעְלָהּ וְשֶׁלֹּא לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ. אֲבָל לֹא לְהַפְסִידָהּ מִכְּתֻבָּתָהּ. אֶלָּא נוֹטֶלֶת כְּתֻבָּתָהּ וְיוֹצְאָה:

Even a woman, a servant, a maid-servant or someone disqualified from testifying because of [the transgression of] a Rabbinic prohibition, and even a relative, may testify with regard to a woman suspected of infidelity, saying that she committed adultery. This causes her to be forbidden to her husband forever, to be prevented from drinking [the bitter water] and to be divorced without receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah. [The rationale is] that since the Torah accepts the testimony of one witness with regard to [the woman's] adultery [we see that the formal laws of testimony do not apply]. Therefore, anyone's testimony is accepted with regard to this matter. Even the five women who we assume hate each other can offer testimony regarding each other, saying that they committed adultery [in these circumstances]. Their testimony is accepted with regard to causing her to be forbidden to her husband and not [to compel her] to drink [the bitter water]. It is not a sufficient basis to cause her to forfeit [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah. Instead, she collects [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah and leaves [his household].

Halachah 16

בָּא עֵד אֶחָד כָּשֵׁר וְאָמַר נִטְמֵאת הֲרֵי זוֹ אֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ. בָּא עֵד אֶחָד וְהִכְחִישׁוֹ וְאָמַר לֹא נִטְמֵאת אֵין שׁוֹמְעִין לוֹ. שֶׁעֵד אֶחָד בְּטֻמְאַת סוֹטָה כִּשְׁנַיִם. וְאֵין דְּבָרָיו שֶׁל אַחֵרוֹן דּוֹחִין דִּבְרֵי הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא כִּשְׁנַיִם:

If one acceptable witness comes and says that the woman committed adultery, she is not required to drink [the bitter water], as we stated. If another witness comes and contradicts his testimony, saying: "She did not commit adultery," the statements [of the second witness] are disregarded. [The rationale is] with regard to a sotah, [the testimony of] one witness is considered equivalent to [that of] two [witnesses in ordinary matters]. Thus, the testimony of the second witness cannot nullify the testimony of the first witness, which is considered to be equivalent to [that of] two witnesses.

Halachah 17

בָּאוּ שְׁנֵיהֶן כְּאֶחָד זֶה אוֹמֵר נִטְמֵאת וְזֶה אוֹמֵר לֹא נִטְמֵאת. אוֹ שֶׁאָמַר אֶחָד נִטְמֵאת וּבָאוּ שְׁנַיִם אֲחֵרִים וְאָמְרוּ לֹא נִטְמֵאת הֲרֵי זוֹ שׁוֹתָה:

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

PARSHAT NOACH

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If, however, both come at the same time and one says: "She committed adultery," and the other says, "She did not commit adultery," or one says: "She committed adultery," and two others say, "She did not commit adultery," she must drink [the bitter water].

Halachah 18

בָּא עֵד אֶחָד כָּשֵׁר וְנָשִׁים רַבּוֹת אוֹ פְּסוּלִין רַבִּים כְּאֶחָד. הָעֵד אוֹמֵר נִטְמֵאת וְהַנָּשִׁים אוֹ הַפְּסוּלִין אוֹמְרִים לֹא נִטְמֵאת הֲרֵי זוֹ שׁוֹתָה. שֶׁעֵד אֶחָד וּפְסוּלִין רַבִּים כְּמֻחֶצָה עַל מֻחֶצָה הֵם:

When one acceptable witness and many women or unacceptable witnesses come at the same time, and the acceptable witness says that the woman committed adultery, while the women or the unacceptable witnesses say that she did not, she is required to drink [the bitter water]. [The rationale is that the testimony of] one acceptable witness and [that of] many unacceptable witnesses are considered to be of equal weight.

Halachah 19

הָיוּ כֻּלָּן פְּסוּלִין הַלֵּךְ אַחַר הָרֹב. כֵּיצַד. שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים אוֹמְרוֹת נִטְמֵאת וְשָׁלֹשׁ אוֹמְרוֹת לֹא נִטְמֵאת הֲרֵי זוֹ שׁוֹתָה. שָׁלֹשׁ אוֹמְרוֹת לֹא נִטְמֵאת וְאַרְבַּע אוֹמְרוֹת נִטְמֵאת הֲרֵי זוֹ אֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה. הָיוּ מֻחֶצָה עַל מֻחֶצָה הֲרֵי זוֹ שׁוֹתָה:

If all the witnesses are unacceptable, the ruling depends on the majority. What is implied? If two women say she committed adultery, and three say she did not, she must drink [the bitter water]. If three say she did not commit adultery and four say that she did, she is not required to drink. If an equal number of women espouse each position, she must drink [the waters].

Halachah 20

כָּל סוֹטָה שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁאֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה מִפְּנֵי עֵדֵי טֻמְאָה הֲרֵי זוֹ אֲסוּרָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ לְעוֹלָם וְתֵצֵא בְּלֹא כְּתֻבָּה שֶׁהֲרֵי נֶאֶסְרָה בְּקִנּוּי וּסְתִירָה. וְהַשְׁתִּיָּה שֶׁתַּתִּירָהּ נִמְנָעָה שֶׁהֲרֵי יֵשׁ בָּהּ עֵד כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ:

In all instances that we said that a sotah should not drink [the waters] because of testimony that she committed adultery, she is forbidden to her husband forever and must be divorced without receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah, for she was forbidden because [she received a] warning and entered into privacy [with the said man]. And she is prevented from drinking the waters, [which could] cause her [to be] permitted, because of the presence of the witness, as we explained.

Commentary

Hilchot Sotah opens not with the ordeal but with its legal trigger — קינוי, the husband's formal warning. All twenty halachot of this chapter map the warning's anatomy: it must be spoken before witnesses, name the man, forbid seclusion with him; the chapter sorts the

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and skylights, warnings and wonders — a reader for Friday and Shabbat

Friday, 16 October 2026 · Aliyah 6+7/7 (Genesis 9:18–11:32) · Daf Bekhorot 28

edge cases of who may warn and how. The Rambam builds the ordeal backwards from its evidentiary foundation: no valid kinui, no sotah. Speech, precisely witnessed, is the first act of the ritual.

The source-tracers do their characteristic work. Migdal Oz pins the opening halachah to Sotah 4a and the tractate's closing sugya (26a), plus the mishnah on the betrothed woman and the yevamah-in-waiting; Kessef Mishneh sends us to the mishnah and gemara at Sotah's opening. The Rambam's spare formulation — “he tells her in the presence of witnesses: do not seclude yourself with so-and-so” — is the Talmud's definition compressed into a legal instrument, every decorative word planed away.

Ohr Sameach, the conceptual analyst, finds the chapter's deep problem: must the witnesses of the warning and the witnesses of the seclusion be the same people? Abaye (Shevuot 4) rules that all agree they need not be — but then the warning-testimony looks like חצי דבר, half-testimony. The Ohr Sameach works the Rif–Tosafot debate on when testimony counts as complete: for Rabbi Akiva, who treats chazakah-witnesses as half-testimony, the same witnesses must testify to both stages; for the Rabbis the question turns on whether the kinui-testimony does anything on its own — and it does, for from the moment of the warning she is forbidden seclusion with that man. A legal speech-act with immediate effect is not half of anything.

The gem: the sotah ritual is the Torah's only ordeal — the one case where the Divine name is erased into water to make peace between husband and wife, God conscripted as the witness of last resort. The Rambam's cold procedural opening is the frame built to hold that fire: before any miracle, words, witnesses, and a warning precisely spoken. And a cross-track echo — Ralbag heard Solomon's Temple prayer (I Kings 8:30) modeling the altar-oath on this very ordeal: the house where every human denial is tested.

Commentary synthesis from Migdal Oz, Kessef Mishneh, and Ohr Sameach on Hilchot Sotah 1:1 (Sefaria). The Daily Rambam advances one chapter a day; the sefer Na'arah Betulah concluded yesterday, so today opens Hilchot Sotah.

DAF YOMI · BEKHOROT 29 (SHABBAT)

Shabbat's daf — text

like Ila in Yavne, whom the Sages in Yavne permitted to take a wage of four issar for issuing a ruling concerning a small animal and six issar for issuing a ruling concerning a large animal. They permitted this provided that he would be paid whether it turned out that the firstborn was unblemished or whether it was blemished.

GEMARA: The Gemara asks: What is the reason that the Sages in Yavne said that Ila could take a wage of four issar for issuing a ruling concerning a small animal but six issar for issuing a ruling concerning a large animal? The Gemara answers: Examining this one, a

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firstborn of a large animal, for blemishes involves great effort; but examining that one, the firstborn of a small animal, does not involve such great effort.

§ The mishna teaches that one like Ila may take his wages provided that he would be paid whether it turns out that the firstborn is unblemished or whether it is blemished. The Gemara inquires: Granted, if the animal is blemished he takes his wages, because he deems the animal permitted to be slaughtered and eaten; but if he examined an unblemished animal, why does he take his wages? The Gemara answers that if so, i.e., if he would be paid for examining only a blemished animal, people would come to suspect him and say that this animal that he declared to be blemished is in fact unblemished, and he declared it blemished and thereby deemed it permitted to be eaten only due to the fact that he wanted to claim his wages.

The Gemara challenges: If so, then in a situation where the examiner is paid either way, people might also state a similar claim with regard to one who rules that it is an unblemished animal. They may suspect that this animal is really blemished, and the reason that this expert did not deem it permitted is that he holds that it is preferable for him to declare it unblemished so that he can collect his wages another time, when he examines it later and declares it blemished. The Gemara answers: The Sages of Yavne instituted an ordinance that he may take his wages for examining a firstborn once, but the Sages did not institute that he may take his wages twice for examining the same animal. Since he will not get paid a second time for the same animal, he has no incentive to declare it unblemished if it has a blemish.

MISHNA: In the case of one who takes his wages to judge cases, his rulings are void. In the case of one who takes wages to testify, his testimonies are void. With regard to one who takes wages to sprinkle the purification waters of the red heifer upon one who contracted impurity imparted by a corpse, and one who takes wages to sanctify those waters, the halakhic status of his water is that of cave water, and the status of his ashes is that of mere burnt ashes.

Although taking actual wages is prohibited, if the one examining the firstborn, or the judge, or the witness, was a priest, and the one who requires his services rendered him impure and prevented him from partaking of his teruma , that person must provide the priest with food, drink, and oil for smearing on his body from his own non-sacred property. And likewise if the one examining the firstborn, or the judge, or the witness, was an elderly person, the one who requires his services transports him on a donkey. And in all these cases, although it is prohibited to take wages, the one who requires his services gives him his wages like the wages of a laborer, as he was unable to perform his usual labor that day.

GEMARA: The mishna teaches that the rulings of one who takes wages to judge cases are void. The Gemara asks: From where is this matter, that a judge may not be paid for his rulings, derived? Rav Yehuda says that Rav says that it is derived from a verse, as the verse

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states: “Behold, I have taught you statutes and ordinances, as the Lord my God commanded me, that you should do so in the midst of the land that you are going in to possess” (Deuteronomy 4:5). This teaches that just as I, Moses, learned the word of God for free, so too, you learned it from me for free, and this is also how you should act with all future generations.

This halakha is also taught in a baraita : “Behold, I have taught you statutes and ordinances, as the Lord my God commanded me” (Deuteronomy 4:5). Just as I learned from God for free, so too, you learned from me for free. And from where is it derived that if one cannot find someone to teach him for free that he should learn even by giving payment? The verse states: “Buy the truth, and do not sell it; also wisdom, and instruction, and understanding” (Proverbs 23:23). And from where is it derived that one should not say: Just as I learned by giving payment, so too, I will teach it by receiving payment? The verse states: “Buy the truth, and do not sell it.”

The mishna teaches: With regard to one who takes wages to sprinkle the purification waters of the red heifer, and one who takes wages to sanctify those waters, the halakhic status of his water is that of cave water, and the status of his ashes is that of mere burnt ashes. This indicates that one may not derive any benefit from the water or ashes of the red heifer. And the Gemara raises a contradiction from a mishna (Kiddushin 58a): With regard to one who betroths a woman with the water of purification, or with the ashes of purification, she is betrothed, and this is the halakha even if the man betrothing her is an Israelite, not a priest or a Levite. This indicates that one may derive benefit from the waters or ashes of purification.

Abaye said: This is not difficult, since there, the mishna in Kiddushin is referring to one who betroths a woman with the value of the payment for bringing the ashes from afar and filling the vessel with the purification water, for which it is permitted to accept payment. Performing this act for the woman is comparable to giving her an item of value, since she will not have to pay someone to bring and fill the vessel for her. Here, the mishna is referring to payment for the actual sprinkling and sanctifying of the ashes.

The Gemara comments: According to this answer, the language of the two mishnayot is also precise, as it teaches here: To sprinkle, or: To sanctify, indicating that he receives payment for the actual sprinkling and sanctification; and it teaches there, in the mishna in Kiddushin , that she is betrothed with the water of purification or with the ashes of purification, which indicates that the water and ashes have not yet been mixed together. The Gemara affirms: Learn from it that this is the correct explanation of the mishnayot .

§ The mishna teaches: Although taking wages is prohibited, if the one examining the firstborn, or the judge, or the witness, was a priest, and the one who required his services rendered him impure and prevented him from partaking of his teruma , he must provide the priest with food, drink, and oil. The Gemara asks: But he himself, the priest, how was he

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permitted to go to a place that caused him to become impure? It is prohibited for a priest to render himself ritually impure.

The Gemara answers that this is referring to a case where he went to an area in which uncertainty exists concerning the location of a grave or a corpse [beit haperas], into which it is prohibited by rabbinic law for a priest to enter. As Rav Yehuda says that Rav says: A person who passes through a beit haperas may blow on the dust before taking each step, which would expose any bone beneath the dust, and walk. A priest may rely on that method of examination and enter the field.

And Rav Yehuda bar Ami says in the name of Rav Yehuda: A beit haperas that has been trodden underfoot, thereby creating a path, is pure, and one no longer needs to be concerned about bones, as the entire prohibition is a stringency by rabbinic law. Nevertheless, a priest who walks through such a field may not partake of teruma until he has purified himself.

Alternatively, the Gemara suggests that the mishna is referring to a case where the priest becomes impure with other forms of impurity, with regard to which priests are not admonished. A priest is prohibited from becoming impure only through contact with a corpse. Yet, he may not partake of teruma if he becomes impure even in any other manner.

§ The mishna teaches: If the one examining the firstborn, or the judge, or the witness, was an elderly person, the one who required his services transports him on a donkey. And in all these cases, although it is prohibited to take wages, the one who required his services gives him his wages like the wages of a laborer, as he was unable to perform his usual labor that day. The Sages taught (Tosefta , Bava Metzia 4:11): The owner gives him his wage as if he were an idle laborer. Abaye says: It means that he is paid as a laborer who is idle from that typical labor of his from which he is kept idle. In other words, he must receive the amount of money a person would be willing to accept to refrain from his current occupation and engage in the actions discussed in the mishna. This calculation accounts for both the degree of difficulty of his steady employment and the amount of his remuneration.

MISHNA: In the case of one who is suspect with regard to firstborn animals of slaughtering them and selling their meat when it is prohibited to do so, one may neither purchase meat from him, including even deer meat, nor may one purchase from him hides that are not tanned. Rabbi Eliezer says: One may purchase hides of female animals from him, as the halakhot of firstborn animals are in effect only with regard to males. And one may not purchase bleached or dirty wool from him. But one may purchase spun thread from him, and all the more so may one purchase garments from him.

GEMARA: The mishna teaches that one may not purchase from him even deer meat. The Gemara explains that the reason is that it could be confused with meat of a calf, as they are similar in appearance.

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The mishna teaches: Nor may one purchase from him hides that are not tanned. The Gemara infers from here that we may purchase tanned hides from one who is suspect with regard to firstborn animals. The reason is that if it is so that it is a hide of a firstborn, he would not make such an effort with it to tan it. This is because he would think: If the Sages hear that this hide is from a firstborn, they will cause me a loss by confiscating it from me.

The mishna teaches that Rabbi Eliezer says: One may purchase hides of female animals from him, as the halakhot of firstborn animals are in effect only with regard to males. The Gemara asks: What is the reason? People know the difference between the hide of a male animal and the hide of a female animal, due to the differences in anatomy.

The Gemara asks: But if so, according to the first tanna , why is it prohibited to purchase hides of female animals from one who is suspect with regard to firstborn animals? The Gemara answers that the first tanna claims as follows: If so, i.e., if it is permitted to purchase hides of female animals, one might also come to sell hides of male animals, as he will sever the male reproductive organ and say that mice ate this part of the hide. The Gemara asks: And the other, Rabbi Eliezer, why is he not concerned that one might cut off that part of the hide and sell it as the hide of a female? The Gemara answers that Rabbi Eliezer maintains that the place of the mice is known, i.e., one can tell by looking at the hide whether it was eaten by mice or cut with a knife.

§ The mishna teaches: And one may not purchase bleached or dirty wool from him. The Gemara asks: Now that the mishna has taught that we may not purchase bleached wool from him, despite the fact he has expended effort in bleaching it, which indicates that it is not from a firstborn, is it necessary to teach that one may not purchase dirty wool from him? The Gemara answers: Rather, the tanna is teaching one case here, that of wool that was bleached and cleaned from its dirt.

The mishna teaches: But one may purchase spun thread from him, and all the more so one may purchase garments from him. The Gemara asks: Now that the mishna has taught that we may purchase spun thread from one who is suspect with regard to firstborn, is it necessary to teach that one may purchase garments? The Gemara answers: What does the mishna mean which it says: Garments? It is referring to felt [namtei] garments, which are not made of spun thread.

MISHNA: In the case of one who is suspect with regard to the Sabbatical Year, i.e., of sowing or engaging in commerce with Sabbatical-Year produce, one may not purchase flax from him, and this applies even to combed flax, in which much labor and exertion was invested. But one may purchase spun thread and woven fabric from such individuals.

GEMARA: The Gemara asks: Now that the mishna has taught that we may purchase spun thread from one who is suspect with regard to the Sabbatical Year, is it necessary to teach the case of woven fabric? The Gemara answers: What does the mishna mean when it says:

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Woven? It means wool woven into chains, which is not spun.

MISHNA: In the case of one who is suspect with regard to selling teruma under the guise of non-sacred produce, one may not purchase even water and salt from him; this is the statement of Rabbi Yehuda. Rabbi Shimon says: One may not purchase from him any item that has relevance to teruma and tithes. However, one may purchase water and salt from him, as teruma and tithes do not apply to them.

GEMARA: The Gemara asks: What is added by Rabbi Shimon's statement that one may not purchase any item that has relevance to teruma and tithes from one who is suspect with regard to selling teruma ? The Gemara answers: Rabbi Shimon's statement serves to add fish innards to this prohibition, as people mix olive oil with them, and it might be oil of teruma .

The Gemara relates: There was a certain butcher who was suspected of selling

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 10:5-6 (SHABBAT)

Shabbat's mishnayot — text

2 mishnayot

Oholot 10:5

אֵין בָּאֲרֻבּוֹת פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה בַבַּיִת, כְּנֶגֶד אֲרֻבּוֹת טָהוֹר. טֻמְאָה כְנֶגֶד אֲרֻבּוֹת, הַבַּיִת טָהוֹר. הַטֻּמְאָה בַבַּיִת, נָתַן בֵּין דָּבָר שֶׁהוּא מְקַבֵּל טֻמְאָה, בֵּין דָּבָר שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְקַבֵּל טֻמְאָה, בֵּין מִלְמַעְלָן בֵּין מִלְמַטָּן, אֵין טָמֵא אֶלָּא הַתַּחְתּוֹן. הַטֻּמְאָה כְנֶגֶד אֲרֻבּוֹת, נָתַן דָּבָר שֶׁהוּא מְקַבֵּל טֻמְאָה, בֵּין מִלְמַעְלָן בֵּין מִלְמַטָּן, הַכֹּל טָמֵא. וְדָבָר שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְקַבֵּל טֻמְאָה, בֵּין מִלְמַעְלָן בֵּין מִלְמַטָּן, אֵין טָמֵא אֶלָּא תַּחְתּוֹן:

In a case where the hatchways do not have an opening of a square handbreadth:If there is uncleanness in the house, what is directly [below] the hatchways remains clean. If there is uncleanness directly [below] the hatchways, the house remains clean. [In the case] where the uncleanness is in the house, if an article whether susceptible to uncleanness or insusceptible to uncleanness was placed either in the upper or the lower [hatchway], nothing becomes unclean except the lower story. [In the case] where the uncleanness is directly [below] the hatchways, if an article susceptible to uncleanness was placed either in the upper or lower [hatchway], everything becomes unclean. If the article is insusceptible to uncleanness, whether [it is placed] in the upper or lower [hatchway], nothing becomes unclean except the lower story.

Oholot 10:6

אֲרֻבָּה שֶׁהִיא בְתוֹךְ הַבַּיִת וּקְדֵרָה נְתוּנָה תַּחְתֶּיהָ, שֶׁאִם תֵּעָלֶה, אֵין שִׁפְתוֹתֶיהָ נוֹגְעוֹת בָּאֲרֻבָּה, טֻמְאָה תַּחְתֶּיהָ, בְּתוֹכָהּ אוֹ עַל גַּבָּהּ, טֻמְאָה בוֹקַעַת וְעוֹלָה, בוֹקַעַת וְיוֹרֶדֶת. הָיְתָה גְבוֹהָה מִן הָאָרֶץ טֶפַח,

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טֻמְאָה תַחְתֶּיהָ, אוֹ בַבַּיִת, תַּחְתֶּיהָ וְהַבַּיִת, טָמֵא. תּוֹכָהּ וְגַבָּהּ, טָהוֹר. בְּתוֹכָהּ אוֹ עַל גַּבָּהּ, הַכֹּל טָמֵא:

In the case of a hatchway in a house with a pot placed below it that, if it was raised, its rims would not touch the [edges of the] hatchway: If there is uncleanness below, within or above [the pot], the uncleanness cleaves upwards and downwards. In the case where [the pot] was one handbreadth high off the ground, if there is uncleanness below it or in the house, what is below it and in the house becomes unclean, but what is within [the pot] or above it, remains clean. [If the uncleanness is] within or above [the pot], everything becomes unclean.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT SOTAH 2 (SHABBAT)

Shabbat's chapter — text

16 halachot

Halachah 1

אִשָּׁה שֶׁקִּנְּאוּ לָהּ וְנִסְתְּרָה אֵין כּוֹפִין אוֹתָהּ לִשְׁתּוֹת. אֶלָּא אִם רָצְתָה וְאָמְרָה הֵן נִטְמֵאתִי תֵּצֵא בְּלֹא כְּתֻבָּה וְנֶאֱסְרָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ לְעוֹלָם וְאֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה. וְכֵן אִם אָמְרָה אֵינִי טְמֵאָה וְאֵינִי שׁוֹתָה אֵין כּוֹפִין אוֹתָהּ לִשְׁתּוֹת וְתֵצֵא בְּלֹא כְּתֻבָּה. וְכֵן אִם אָמַר בַּעְלָהּ אֵינִי רוֹצֶה לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ אוֹ שֶׁבְּעָלָהּ בַּעְלָהּ אַחַר שֶׁנִּסְתְּרָה הֲרֵי זוֹ אֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה וְנוֹטֶלֶת כְּתֻבָּתָהּ וְיוֹצְאָה וְהִיא אֲסוּרָה [עָלָיו] לְעוֹלָם:

When a woman is given a warning and enters into privacy [with the man in question], she is not compelled to drink the bitter water. Instead, if she says, "I committed adultery," she is not required to drink the waters, but she must be divorced without receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah, and she is forbidden to her husband forever. Similarly, if she says: "I did not commit adultery, but I will not drink the waters," 1 Although she claims innocence, she is still afraid of drinking the waters. See Chapter 4, Halachah 3. she is not forced to drink, but she must be divorced without receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah. And if her husband says, "I don't want to have her drink," or if he engaged in relations with her after she entered into privacy [with the man in question], she should not drink [the bitter water]. 2 As stated in Chapter 1, Halachah 2, from the time the woman enters into privacy with the man in question, her husband is forbidden to enter into relations with her. As such, if they engaged in relations, the bitter water will not show her guilt, as indicated by Halachah 8. Instead, she is given [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah 3 Because it is her husband's actions that prevent her from drinking the waters that can establish her innocence, he must bear the financial responsibility. and departs; she is forbidden to him forever.

Halachah 2

וְאֵלּוּ הֵן הַנָּשִׁים שֶׁאֵינָן רְאוּיוֹת לִשְׁתּוֹת אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהֵן רוֹצוֹת לִשְׁתּוֹת וּבַעְלֵיהֶן רוֹצִים לְהַשְׁקוֹתָן אֶלָּא

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and skylights, warnings and wonders — a reader for Friday and Shabbat

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יוֹצְאוֹת בְּלֹא כְתֻבָּה מִשֶּׁיָּבוֹאוּ עֲדֵי סְתִירָה אַחַר עֵדֵי קִנּוּי וְיֵאָסְרוּ עַל בַּעְלֵיהֶן לְעוֹלָם. וַחֲמֵשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה נָשִׁים הֵן. וְאֵלּוּ הֵן. אֲרוּסָה. וְשׁוֹמֶרֶת יָבָם. וּקְטַנָּה אֵשֶׁת הַגָּדוֹל. וּגְדוֹלָה אֵשֶׁת הַקָּטָן. וְאֵשֶׁת אַנְדְּרוֹגִינוּס. וְאֵשֶׁת הַסּוּמָא. וְאֵשֶׁת הַחֵגֵר אוֹ הָאִלֵּם. אוֹ מִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ שׁוֹמֵעַ. אוֹ שֶׁהוּא כְּרוּת יָד. וְכֵן הַחִגֶּרֶת. וְהָאִלֶּמֶת. וְהַסּוּמָא. וּכְרוּתַת יָד. וְשֶׁאֵינָהּ שׁוֹמַעַת. כָּל אַחַת מֵאֵלּוּ אֵינָהּ רְאוּיָה לִשְׁתּוֹת:

The following women are not fit to drink [the bitter water] even though they desire to drink, and their husbands desire to have them drink. Instead, once witnesses testify that [such women] entered into privacy with the men in question after witnesses testify that a warning was granted, they are forbidden to their husbands and must be divorced without receiving [the money due them by virtue of] their ketubah. There are fifteen such women; they are: a woman who was consecrated but the marriage bond was not consummated, a yevamah who is waiting for her husband's brother to perform yibbum, 4 The commentaries raise a question based on Hilchot Yibbum 2:20, which states that when a yevamah engages in relations with another man, she does not become forbidden to her yavam. They explain that an exception is made when the yavam issues a warning and forbids the yevamah to enter into privacy with a particular man. a minor married to a man past the age of majority, a woman who is past majority who is married to a minor, the wife of an androgynous, 5 A person who has both male and female sexual organs. the wife of a blind man, the wife of a man who limps, who cannot speak, who is deaf, or whose hand has been cut off, and similarly, a woman who limps, who cannot speak, who is blind, whose hand has been cut off, or who is deaf. All the above are not fit to drink [the bitter water]. 6 If they violate a warning given by their husbands and enter into privacy with the man in question, they are to be divorced without receiving the money due them by virtue of their ketubah.

Halachah 3

וּמִנַּיִן שֶׁאֵינָהּ רְאוּיָה לִשְׁתּוֹת שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה כט) "אֲשֶׁר תִּשְׂטֶה אִשָּׁה תַּחַת אִישָׁהּ". תַּחַת פְּרָט לַאֲרוּסָה וְשׁוֹמֶרֶת יָבָם שֶׁאֵינָהּ תַּחַת אִישָׁהּ. אִשָּׁה פְּרָט לִקְטַנָּה. תַּחַת אִישָׁהּ פְּרָט לְאֵשֶׁת קָטָן וְאֵשֶׁת אַנְדְּרוֹגִינוּס שֶׁאֵינוֹ אִישׁ. (במדבר ה יג) "וְנֶעֱלָם מֵעֵינֵי אִישָׁהּ" פְּרָט לְאֵשֶׁת סוּמָא. (במדבר ה יח) "וְהֶעֱמִיד הַכֹּהֵן אֶת הָאִשָּׁה" פְּרָט לְחִגֶּרֶת. (במדבר ה יח) "וְנָתַן עַל כַּפֶּיהָ" פְּרָט לְמִי שֶׁאֵין לָהּ כַּף אוֹ שֶׁהָיְתָה עֲקֻמָּה אוֹ יְבֵשָׁה שֶׁאֵינָהּ יְכוֹלָה לִקַּח בָּהּ. וַאֲפִלּוּ כַּפָּהּ אַחַת שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כַּפֶּיהָ. וְאָמְרָה הָאִשָּׁה פְּרָט לְאִלֶּמֶת. (במדבר ה יט) "וְאָמַר אֶל הָאִשָּׁה" פְּרָט לְמִי שֶׁאֵינָהּ שׁוֹמַעַת. וַהֲרֵי הוּא אוֹמֵר אֲשֶׁר תִּשְׂטֶה אִשָּׁה תַּחַת אִישָׁהּ עַד שֶׁתְּהֵיֶה שְׁלֵמָה כְּמוֹהוּ וְהוּא שֶׁלֹּא כְּמוֹתָהּ. הָא לְמַדְתָּ שֶׁכָּל דָּבָר שֶׁמְּעַכֵּב אוֹתָהּ מִלִּשְׁתּוֹת מְעַכֵּב אֶת בַּעְלָהּ מִלְּהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ. וְכָל הַמְעַכֵּב אֶת הַבַּעַל מִלְּהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ מוּם כָּמוֹהוּ מְעַכֵּב אוֹתָהּ מִלִּשְׁתּוֹת:

What are the sources that exclude these women from drinking [the bitter water]? [Numbers 5:29] states: "When a woman deviates [from the paths of modesty] while married to her husband...." "While married" excludes a woman who was consecrated, but the marriage

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bond was not consummated, and a yevamah who is waiting for her husband's brother to perform yibbum. "Her husband" excludes a minor married to a man past the age of majority. 7 When a girl below majority was not consecrated by her father, the consecration is not effective by Scriptural law. Even when she was consecrated by her father, she is not required to drink the bitter water unless she is warned after attaining majority. (See Halachah 4.) Note the Kessef Mishneh, who quotes a different source from that mentioned by the Rambam. "While married to her husband" excludes a woman who is past majority who is married to a minor 8 A woman consecrated by a minor is not considered consecrated at all (Hilchot Ishut 4:7)., and the wife of an androgynous, for he is not a man. 9 As stated in Hilchot Ishut 4;11, when an androgynous consecrates a woman, the status of the kiddushin is in doubt. [Numbers 5:13 states:] "And it was hidden from the eyes of her husband" - This excludes the wife of a blind man. 10 Who could not see, even when the two did not act in secrecy (Sotah 27a). "And the priest shall have the woman stand" [Ibid. :18] - This excludes a woman who limps. "And he shall place on her palm" [Ibid.] - This excludes a woman who does not have a hand or whose hand is crooked or shrunk to the extent that she cannot hold [the meal offering]. This applies even if only one hand is in this condition, for the verse uses the plural form of the word palm, [indicating that both hands must be fit to perform this act]. "And the woman shall say" [Ibid. :22] - This excludes a woman who cannot speak. "And he shall say to the woman" [Ibid. :19] - This excludes a woman who cannot hear. And [the passage continues, Ibid. :20:] "When a woman deviates [from the path of modesty] while married to her husband..." - This indicates that she must be of sound body, possessing all the physical characteristics [mentioned previously] that he possesses, and he [must possess the characteristics mentioned that she possesses]. This teaches that any physical factor that prevents her from drinking [the bitter water] prevents her husband from compelling her to drink. And any factor that prevents her husband from compelling her to drink prevents her from drinking.

Halachah 4

קְטַנָּה שֶׁהִשִּׂיאָהּ אָבִיהָ אִם זִנְּתָה בִּרְצוֹנָהּ נֶאֱסְרָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ. לְפִיכָךְ מְקַנְּין לָהּ לֹא לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ אֶלָּא לְפָסְלָהּ מִכְּתֻבָּתָהּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. אֲבָל קְטַנָּה בַּת מֵאוֹן אֵין מְקַנְּין לָהּ שֶׁאֵין לָהּ רָצוֹן לְהֵאָסֵר עַל בַּעְלָהּ. וְאֶפִלּוּ הָיָה כֹּהֵן לֹא נֶאֱסְרָה עָלָיו:

When a minor is married off by her father, she is forbidden to her husband if she willingly commits adultery. Therefore, she is given a warning, not to compel her to drink [the bitter water], but so that she will be denied [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah, as stated above. 11 The Ra'avad differs with the Rambam's ruling, maintaining that a minor is never forbidden to her husband because of adultery unless he is a priest, basing his opinion on Yevamot 33b, which states: "The seduction of a minor is always considered equivalent to rape." In his gloss on Hilchot Issurei Bi'ah 3:2, the Maggid Mishneh substantiates the

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Rambam's ruling, citing Ketubot 9a, which states that the statements of a husband who claims that his wife is not a virgin are accepted and cause her to be forbidden to him. According to the Rambam, this applies even when the girl is a minor. (See also the Kessef Mishneh.) With regard to a minor who is entitled to nullify her marriage through mi'un, 12 I.e., an orphan who was married off by someone other than her father. See Hilchot Ishut 4:8; Hilchot Gerushin 11:1. by contrast, no warning is given, for she has no desire to be forbidden to her husband. [Even if she commits adultery,] she is not forbidden to her husband, even if he is a priest. 13 Since according to Scriptural law, her marriage is not binding, relations with another man are not considered adulterous. Even a priest who may not marry a woman who engaged in a forbidden sexual relationship may remain married to this girl.

Halachah 5

קִנֵּא לָאֵרוּסָתוֹ אוֹ לְזִקּוּקָתוֹ וְנִסְתְּרָה אַחַר שֶׁנִּשְׂאָה הֲרֵי זוֹ שׁוֹתָה כִּשְׁאָר כָּל הַנָּשִׁים. נִשּׂוֹאָה שֶׁקִּנֵּא לָהּ וְנִסְתְּרָה קֹדֶם שֶׁיִּבְעל אוֹתָהּ בַּעְלָהּ אֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה וְיוֹצְאָה בְּלֹא כְּתֻבָּה וַאֲסוּרָה עָלָיו לְעוֹלָם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה כ) "וַיִּתֵּן אִישׁ בָּךְ אֶת שְׁכָבְתּוֹ מִבַּלְעֲדֵי אִישֶׁךְ" שֶׁקְּדָמָה שְׁכִיבַת בַּעַל לִשְׁכִיבַת בּוֹעֵל:

When a man issues a warning to a woman he consecrated or to his yevamah, and she entered into privacy [with the man in question] after [the husband] consummated their marriage, she must drink [the bitter water] like any other [married] woman. 14 Although these women are not required to drink if they enter into privacy with the man in question before the marriage is consummated, after its consummation the warning issued beforehand is effective. When a husband issued a warning to his wife and she enters into privacy [with the man in question] before her husband engaged in sexual relations with her, 15 I.e., the husband and the wife entered into a chuppah, effecting the stage of nisu'in. They did not, however, consummate the marriage. Before they did so, the wife entered into privacy with the man in question. she does not drink [the bitter water]. Instead, she is divorced without receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah and is forbidden to her husband forever. [This is alluded to by Numbers 5:20, which] states: "And another man has lain with you other than your husband," [implied is] that relations with the husband preceded relations with the man in question.

Halachah 6

הַגִּיֹּרֶת וְהַמְשֻׁחְרֶרֶת וְאֵשֶׁת הַגֵּר וְאֵשֶׁת עֶבֶד מְשֻׁחְרָר וּמַמְזֶרֶת וְאֵשֶׁת מַמְזֵר וְאֵשֶׁת סְרִיס חַמָּה אוֹ סְרִיס אָדָם הַמֻּתָּרוֹת לְבַעְלֵיהֶן הֲרֵי הֵן כְּכָל הַנָּשִׁים וְשׁוֹתוֹת:

[The following women are judged] like all other married women - who are permitted to remain married - and are required to drink [the bitter water if they violated a husband's warning]: a convert, a freed maidservant, the wife of a convert, the wife of a freed servant, a woman who is of illegitimate parenthood, the wife of a man of illegitimate parenthood

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and the wife of an impotent man - whether he became impotent naturally or through an act of man. 16 The words "who are permitted to remain married" are fundamental to the understanding of this halachah. All these women and/or their husbands mentioned are bound by different laws with regard to marriage from the Jewish people as a whole. Nevertheless, if they are permitted to their husbands or to their wives, the laws of a sotah apply. As such, an illegitimate man or woman must be married either to another illegitimate man or woman or to a convert, as stated in Hilchot Issurei Bi'ah, Chapter 15. With regard to an impotent man, the laws regarding whom he is permitted to marry and whom he is forbidden to marry are stated in Hilchot Issurei Bi'ah, Chapter 16.

Halachah 7

מְעֻבֶּרֶת וּמֵינִיקָה מְקַנֵּא לָהּ וּמַשְׁקֶה אוֹתָהּ כְּמוֹת שֶׁהִיא. אִשָּׁה הָעוֹמֶדֶת לִשְׁתּוֹת וּמֵת בַּעְלָהּ קוֹדֶם שֶׁתִּשְׁתֶּה אֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה וְלֹא נוֹטֶלֶת כְּתֻבָּתָהּ׃

A pregnant woman and a nursing woman are required to drink [the bitter water] in their present state. 17 We do not wait for her to give birth or for her to wean her child. Note Tosafot, Sotah 26a, who differ and maintain that we should wait for a pregnant woman to give birth before requiring her to drink. When a woman is required to drink [the bitter water], but her husband dies before she has the opportunity of doing so, she should neither drink 18 For her husband is no longer alive. nor collect [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah. 19 For she did not prove her innocence by drinking the waters.

Halachah 8

כָּל אִישׁ שֶׁבָּא בְיִאָה אֲסוּרָה מִיָּמָיו אַחַר שֶׁהִגְדִּיל אֵין הַמַּיִם הַמְאָרְרִים בּוֹדְקִין אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ. וַאֲפִלּוּ בָּא עַל אֲרוּסָתוֹ בְּבֵית חָמִיו שֶׁאָסוּר מִדִּבְרֵי סוֹפְרִים אֵין הַמַּיִם בּוֹדְקִין אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה לא) "וְנִקָּה הָאִישׁ מֵעָוֹן וְהָאִשָּׁה הַהִיא תִּשָּׂא אֶת עֲוֹנָהּ". בְּזְמַן שֶׁהָאִישׁ מְנֻקֶּה מֵעָוֹן אִשָּׁה נוֹשְׂאָה אֶת עֲוֹנָהּ׃

Whenever a man has engaged in forbidden relations from the time he attained majority onward, the curse-bearing waters 20 The term is taken from Numbers 5:18. do not test [the fidelity of] his wife. Even if he engaged in relations with the woman he consecrated while she was living in her father's house - which is a Rabbinic prohibition 21 See Hilchot Ishut 10:1. The Ra'avad differs with the Rambam regarding this point, maintaining that Sotah 24b appears to indicate that the wife of a man who had relations with the woman he consecrated while she was living in her father's house must still drink the bitter water. The Kessef Mishneh justifies the Rambam's ruling. - the waters do not test [the fidelity of] his wife. [This is derived from Numbers 5:31, which] states: "The man will then be free of sin, and the woman will bear [the burden of] her sin." [Implied is that] when the man is "free of sin," "the woman will bear [the burden of] her sin."

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Halachah 9

לְפִיכָךְ אִם הָיְתָה אִשְׁתּוֹ אֲסוּרָה עָלָיו מֵחַיָּבֵי לָאוִין אוֹ מֵחַיָּבֵי עֲשֵׂה אֲפִלּוּ שְׁנִיָּה וְקִנֵּא לָהּ וְנִסְתְּרָה אֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה אֶלָּא תֵּצֵא בְּלֹא כְתֻבָּה וְתִהְיֶה אֲסוּרָה עָלָיו אַף מִשּׁוּם זֶה. עָבַר וְנָשָׂא מְעֻבֶּרֶת חֲבֵרוֹ וּמֵינֶקֶת חֲבֵרוֹ הֲרֵי זוֹ שׁוֹתָה שֶׁאֵין כָּאן עֲבֵרָה:

Therefore, if a man's wife is forbidden to him because of a negative commandment, a positive commandment, or even [a Rabbinic prohibition - e.g.,] a sh'niyah, and he warned her and she entered into privacy [with the man in question], she should not drink [the bitter water]. 22 For by engaging in relations with his wife, the man has transgressed a prohibition, and hence the waters will not test his wife's fidelity. Instead, she should be divorced and should not receive [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah. She becomes forbidden to him for this reason as well. When a man transgresses and marries a woman who was made pregnant by another man, or who is nursing a child she bore by another man, she may [be compelled to] drink [the bitter water], since there is no transgression involved [in their relationship]. 23 It is forbidden to marry such women, as stated in Hilchot Gerushin 11:25. Nevertheless, since the prohibition is not inherent to the couple's relationship - as reflected in the fact that after the 24 months of nursing have passed, the couple may marry - but rather a result of the child's presence, it is not considered a sinful relationship. See the gloss of the Kessef Mishneh and the Mishneh LaMelech. The Rambam's wording here implies that the faithfulness of the sotah should be tested immediately. From his Commentary to the Mishnah (Sotah 4:3), it would appear that the couple are compelled to separate until the 24 months pass. Afterwards, if the husband desires to resume his relationship with his wife, she must drink the bitter water.

Halachah 10

מִי שֶׁאֵין לוֹ אִשָּׁה הָרְאוּיָה לֵילֵד וְלֹא בָּנִים וְנָשָׂא עֲקָרָה אוֹ זְקֵנָה אוֹ אֵילוֹנִית אֵינָהּ שׁוֹתָה וְלֹא נוֹטֶלֶת כְּתֻבָּה. הָיוּ לוֹ בָּנִים אוֹ אִשָּׁה אַחֶרֶת רְאוּיָה לֵילֵד הֲרֵי זֶה מַשְׁקֶה אוֹתָהּ אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהִיא זְקֵנָה אוֹ עֲקָרָה אוֹ אֵילוֹנִית וְאֵינָהּ רְאוּיָה לֵילֵד שֶׁלֹּא נֶאֱמַר בַּתּוֹרָה (במדבר ה כח) "וְנִזְרְעָה זָרַע" אֶלָּא בִּרְאוּיָה לֵילֵד שֶׁאִם הָיְתָה יוֹלֶדֶת בְּצַעַר תֵּלֵד בְּרֶוַח. הָיָה דִּרְכָּהּ לֵילֵד נְקֵבוֹת תֵּלֵד זְכָרִים:

When a man is not married to a woman capable of bearing children, nor has he [fathered] children in [a previous marriage], and he marries a barren woman, a woman past the age of child-bearing or an aylonit, [the marriage is not considered desirable in the eyes of the Sages]. 24 Every Jew is commanded to be fruitful and multiply. For this reason, as the Rambam states in Hilchot Ishut 15:7, the husband is obligated to divorce this woman. Therefore, she is not given the opportunity to demonstrate her fidelity by drinking the bitter water. [Therefore,] such a woman may not drink [the bitter water], nor does she receive [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah [if the husband divorces her for violating his warning]. If, however, [the husband] has [already fathered] children, or he has

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

PARSHAT NOACH

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Friday, 16 October 2026 · Aliyah 6+7/7 (Genesis 9:18–11:32) · Daf Bekhorot 28

another wife capable of bearing children, he may compel [his other wife] to drink [the bitter water] even if she is past the age of child-bearing, barren or an aylonit, and thus incapable of giving birth. 25 Significantly, the Rambam's ruling here reflects a change of mind from his ruling in his Commentary on the Mishnah (Sotah 4:3) where he rules that such women may not drink the bitter water even when the husband has fathered children already. For the Torah's statement, [Numbers 5:28] "And she will be cleared and she will conceive" applies solely to a woman capable of giving birth, 26 It is not, however, an exclusion preventing a woman who is not capable of bearing children from drinking the waters. See Sotah 25b. See the gloss of the Ra'avad. [implying] that if previously she would give birth in pain, she will give birth comfortably; if previously she would give birth to daughters, she will give birth to sons.

Halachah 11

הָיוּ לוֹ אִשָּׁה וּבָנִים וּמֵתוּ בֵּין קִנּוּי לִסְתִירָה כְּבָר נִרְאֵית לִשְׁתּוֹת וּמַשְׁקֶה אוֹתָהּ. לֹא הָיוּ לוֹ בָּנִים וְלֹא אִשָּׁה הָרְאוּיָה לְיֹלֶד אֶלָּא זוֹ הָאַיְלוֹנִית וְכַיּוֹצֵא בָּהּ וְנוֹלַד לוֹ בֵּן מִגְּרוּשָׁתוֹ בֵּין קִנּוּי לִסְתִירָה כְּבָר נִדְחֵית הָאַיְלוֹנִית מִלִּשְׁתּוֹת׃

If [a husband] had [another] wife [capable of bearing children] or had children, but they died between the time when the warning was issued and the time the woman entered into privacy [with the man in question], the woman was already fit to drink the bitter water, and she should be compelled to drink. If [a husband] did not have children or [another] wife capable of bearing children aside from an aylonit or another woman [incapable of bearing children], and his divorcee bore him a son 27 I.e., he was married to an aylonit and a woman capable of bearing children. The woman capable of bearing children became pregnant, he divorced her and then issued a warning to the aylonit. between the time when the warning was issued and the time the woman entered into privacy [with the man in question], the aylonit was already excluded from drinking [and that ruling remains].

Halachah 12

כָּל אִשָּׁה שֶׁהָיָה לָהּ קִנּוּי וּסְתִירָה וְלֹא שָׁתְתָה מֵי הַמָּרִים בֵּין שֶׁלֹּא רָצָה בַּעְלָהּ לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ בֵּין שֶׁלֹּא רָצְתָה הִיא וּבֵין שֶׁבָּא לָהּ עֵד טֻמְאָה אוֹ הוֹדֵית אוֹ הָיְתָה מֵאֵלּוּ הַנָּשִׁים שֶׁאֵינָן רְאוּיוֹת לִשְׁתּוֹת אוֹ שֶׁקִּנְאוּ לָהּ בֵּית דִּין. הוֹאִיל וְנֶאֱסְרָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ מִכָּל מָקוֹם הֲרֵי הִיא אֲסוּרָה עַל זֶה שֶׁנִּתְיַחֲדָה עִמּוֹ לְעוֹלָם כְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁהִיא אֲסוּרָה עַל בַּעְלָהּ. וְאִם עָבַר וּנְשָׂאָהּ מוֹצִיאִין אוֹתָהּ מִתַּחְתָּיו בְּגֵט אֲפִלּוּ הָיוּ לָהּ כַּמָּה בָּנִים מִמֶּנּוּ. מִפִּי הַשְּׁמוּעָה לָמְדוּ כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאֲסוּרָה לַבַּעַל כָּךְ אֲסוּרָה לַבּוֹעֵל׃

Whenever a warning was administered to a woman and she entered into privacy [with the man in question], but did not drink the bitter water - whether her husband did not desire to compel her to drink, she did not want to drink, a witness testified that she committed adultery, she was one of the women who are unfit to drink [the bitter water], 28 See

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

PARSHAT NOACH

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Halachah 2. or the warning was administered by the court [and not by her husband] 29 See Chapter 1, Halachot 10-11. - since she becomes forbidden to her husband, she also becomes forbidden to the man with whom she entered into privacy just as she is forbidden to her husband. 30 I.e., if her husband divorces her, it is forbidden for her to marry the man concerning whom she was warned. If this other man transgresses and marries her, he is compelled to divorce her even if she has borne him many children. Based on the Oral Tradition our Sages taught: Just as she is forbidden to her husband, she is forbidden to the man with whom she engaged in relations. 31 This principle applies not only with regard to a sotah, but with regard to every adulterous relationship. The passage in the Torah mentions the word v'nitma'ah ("and she became defiled") twice, once in reference to the husband and once in reference to the adulterer. See Hilchot Gerushin 5:4-5. See also Halachah 15.

Halachah 13

אֲבָל אִם לֹא קִדַּם קִנּוּי וּבָאוּ עָלֶיהָ עֵדִים שֶׁנִּסְתְּרָה עִם אִישׁ זֶה וּבָאוּ וּמָצְאוּ דָּבָר מְכֹעָר כְּגוֹן שֶׁנִּכְנְסוּ אַחֲרָיו וּמָצְאוּהָ חוֹגֶרֶת חֲגוֹרָה. אוֹ מָצְאוּ רֹק לְמַעְלָה מִן הַכִּילָה וְכֵיוֹצֵא בָּזֶה. אִם הוֹצִיאָהּ בַּעְלָהּ בְּדָבָר מְכֹעָר כָּזֶה הֲרֵי זוֹ לֹא תִנָּשֵׂא לַנִּטְעָן אֶלָּא אֲסוּרָה עָלָיו. וְאִם עָבַר וּנְשָׂאָהּ וְהָיוּ לָהּ בָּנִים מִמֶּנּוּ לֹא תֵּצֵא. וְאִם לֹא הָיוּ לָהּ בָּנִים מִמֶּנּוּ תֵּצֵא:

[Different rules apply when,] however, a woman was not warned and witnesses came and testified that she entered into privacy with a man, and then they discovered unsavory behavior: e.g., they entered [her room] after [the man in question did] and saw her tying her belt, they found wet spittle on the bed's canopy, 32 This indicates that someone was lying face up on the bed and could not turn to either side (Rashi, Yevamot 24a). See Hilchot Ishut 24:15 and notes, where these concepts are discussed in greater detail. or the like. If her husband divorces her because of this unsavory behavior, 33 He is not, however, compelled to divorce her. The matter is left to his initiative (Kessef Mishneh; Beit Shmuel 11:6). she should not marry the man with whom she is suspected [of having relations]; instead, she should be forbidden to him. If she transgresses and marries [this man] and children are born to them, she need not be divorced. 34 Since there is no conclusive evidence that she is forbidden, she is allowed to remain married, so that the reputation of her children will not be sullied. If she has not borne [this man] children, he must divorce her.

Halachah 14

בַּמֶּה דְּבָרִים אֲמוּרִים בְּשֶׁרִנְּנוּ הָעִיר עָלֶיהָ וְעַל הַנִּטְעָן יוֹם וּמֶחֱצָה אוֹ יוֹתֵר. וְאָמְרוּ פְּלוֹנִי זְנָה עִם פְּלוֹנִית וְלֹא פָּסַק הַקּוֹל. וְהוּא שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ לָהּ אוֹ לוֹ אוֹיְבִים שֶׁמַּעֲבִירִין אֶת הַקּוֹל. אֲבָל אִם לֹא הָיְתָה שָׁם רִנָּה לְדָבָר זֶה בָּעִיר אוֹ שֶׁפָּסַק הַקּוֹל שֶׁלֹּא מֵחֲמַת יִרְאָה. אִם נִשֵּׂאת לַנִּטְעָן לֹא תֵּצֵא אַף עַל פִּי

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and skylights, warnings and wonders — a reader for Friday and Shabbat

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שֶׁאֵין לָהּ בָּנִים. אֲפִלּוּ בָּא עֵד אֶחָד שֶׁזִּנְּתָה עִמּוֹ לֹא תֵּצֵא:

When does the above apply? When [the inhabitants of] a city gossiped about the man and woman in question for a day and a half or more, saying: "So and so committed adultery with so and so," and this rumor did not cease. [Moreover, this applies] only when neither [the man nor the woman in question] have enemies who spread this rumor. 35 The Ramah (Even HaEzer 11:1) differs and maintains that if there are both a rumor that continues spreading throughout the city, and witnesses who saw unsavory behavior, the husband is required to divorce his wife if she has not borne him children [Shulchan Aruch (Even HaEzer 11:2)]. If, however, the rumor was not widespread throughout the city, or the rumor ceased for reasons other than fear [different rules apply]. If she marries [the man in question], she need not be divorced although she has not borne him any children. Even when one witness comes and testifies that she committed adultery with him, she need not be divorced. 36 If, however, two witnesses testify to adultery, the adulterer is compelled to divorce her, as stated above.

Halachah 15

מִי שֶׁהוֹצִיאָהּ בַּעְלָהּ בְּעֵדֵי דָּבָר מְכֹעָר וְנִשֵּׂאת לְאַחֵר וְגֵרְשָׁהּ הֲרֵי זוֹ אֲסוּרָה לְהִנָּשֵׂא לַנִּטְעָן שֶׁיָּצָאתָה מִתַּחַת בַּעְלָהּ בְּגָלָלוֹ. וְאִם נִשֵּׂאת לֹא תֵּצֵא אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵין לָהּ בָּנִים:

If a woman who was divorced by her [first] husband for unsavory behavior marries another man and is later divorced by him, she is forbidden to marry the man because of whom she was divorced by her first husband. If, however, she marries him, he is not compelled to divorce her even though she has not borne him children. 37 Although the couple are forbidden to marry, since there were no witnesses to the act of adultery, and the second marriage interposed, a more lenient ruling is given than that stated in Halachah 13.

Halachah 16

כָּל אִשָּׁה שֶׁבָּאוּ שְׁנֵי עֵדִים וְהֵעִידוּ שֶׁזִּנְּתָה עִם זֶה כְּשֶׁהָיְתָה תַּחַת בַּעְלָהּ הָרִאשׁוֹן הֲרֵי זוֹ תֵּצֵא מִזֶּה. וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהּ מִמֶּנּוּ כַּמָּה בָּנִים. וְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ תֵּצֵא תֵּצֵא בְּלֹא כְתֻבָּה:

Whenever two witnesses testify that, while she was married to another man, a woman committed adultery 38 The Chelkat Mechokek 11:10 emphasizes that this law applies only when the woman willingly committed adultery. If she was raped while married to her first husband, she does not become forbidden to him. Moreover, she also does not become forbidden to the rapist, and if she is widowed or divorced, she is permitted to marry him. with the man to whom she is presently married, she must be divorced by her present husband even though she has borne him several children. In all the instances where we said that a woman must be divorced, she is not entitled to receive [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah. 39 For it is her immodest conduct that caused her to be forbidden.

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and skylights, warnings and wonders — a reader for Friday and Shabbat

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GOV.IL ·

The government on this week's learning

One live government service meets the daf head-on: the Chief Rabbinate's permit system for firstborn livestock — the modern bureaucracy of the very institution Bekhorot 28 regulates.

בקשה לקבלת היתר למכירת בכורות בקר או צאן

הרבנות הראשית לישראל

The daf's baraita already worries about “a firstborn in the present time, when there is no Temple” — and this gov.il service page is today's answer: farmers apply to the Chief Rabbinate for a permit to sell firstborn cattle or sheep, part of the coordinated pre-birth sale (מכירת מבכירות) that keeps the sanctity from attaching, with a central sale before Passover and monthly sales through the year.

https://www.gov.il/he/service/permit-to-sell-the-firstborns-of-cattle-or-sheep

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYOT 6–7

Genesis 9:18–11:32

76 verses

The shnayim mikra practice — each verse twice in Hebrew, once in Targum Onkelos — meets the week's two closing aliyot as one continuous reading: Noach's vineyard and the curse of Canaan, the Table of Nations, the Tower of Babel, and Shem's line narrowing to Terach. Seventy-six verses, from the morning after the flood to the threshold of Abraham.

Genesis 9:18 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ בְנֵי־נֹחַ הַיֹּצְאִים מִן־הַתֵּבָה שֵׁם וְחָם וְיֶפֶת וְחָם הוּא אֲבִי כְנָעַן׃
וַיִּהְיוּ בְנֵי־נֹחַ הַיֹּצְאִים מִן־הַתֵּבָה שֵׁם וְחָם וְיֶפֶת וְחָם הוּא אֲבִי כְנָעַן׃
וַהֲווֹ בְנֵי נֹחַ דְּי נְפָקוּ מִן תֵּבוּתָא שֵׁם וְחָם וְיָפֶת וְחָם הוּא אֲבוּהִי דִכְנָעַן׃

Genesis 9:19 · ×2

שְׁלֹשָׁה אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי־נֹחַ וּמֵאֵלֶּה נָפְצָה כָל־הָאָרֶץ׃
שְׁלֹשָׁה אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי־נֹחַ וּמֵאֵלֶּה נָפְצָה כָל־הָאָרֶץ׃
תְּלָתָא אִלֵּין בְּנֵי נֹחַ וּמֵאִלֵּין אִתְבַּדַּרוּ כָּל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 9:20 · ×2

וַיָּחֶל נֹחַ אִישׁ הָאֲדָמָה וַיִּטַּע כָּרֶם׃
וַיָּחֶל נֹחַ אִישׁ הָאֲדָמָה וַיִּטַּע כָּרֶם׃
וְשָׁרֵי נֹחַ גְּבַר פַּלַּח בַּאַרְעָא וּנְצִיב כַּרְמָא׃

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

DAILY READER

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Genesis 9:21 · ×2

וַיֵּשְׁתְּ מִן־הַיַּיִן וַיִּשְׁכָּר וַיִּתְגַּל בְּתוֹךְ אָהֳלָה׃
וַיֵּשְׁתְּ מִן־הַיַּיִן וַיִּשְׁכָּר וַיִּתְגַּל בְּתוֹךְ אָהֳלָה׃
וּשְׁתִי מִן חַמְרָא וּרְוִי וְאִתְגְּלִי בְּגוֹ מַשְׁכְּנֵיהּ׃

Genesis 9:22 · ×2

וַיַּרְא חָם אֲבִי כְנַעַן אֵת עֶרְוַת אָבִיו וַיַּגֶּד לִשְׁנֵי־אֶחָיו בַּחוּץ׃
וַיַּרְא חָם אֲבִי כְנַעַן אֵת עֶרְוַת אָבִיו וַיַּגֶּד לִשְׁנֵי־אֶחָיו בַּחוּץ׃
וַחֲזָא חָם אֲבוּהִי דִכְנַעַן יָת עֶרְיָתָא דַּאֲבוּהִי וְחַוִי לְתַרֵין אֲחוֹהִי בְּשׁוּקָא׃

Genesis 9:23 · ×2

וַיִּקַּח שֵׁם וָיֶפֶת אֶת־הַשִּׂמְלָה וַיָּשִׂימוּ עַל־שְׁכֶם שְׁנֵיהֶם וַיֵּלְכוּ אֲחֹרַנִּית וַיְכַסּוּ אֵת עֶרְוַת אֲבִיהֶם וּפְנֵיהֶם אֲחֹרַנִּית וְעֶרְוַת אֲבִיהֶם לֹא רָאוּ׃
וַיִּקַּח שֵׁם וָיֶפֶת אֶת־הַשִּׂמְלָה וַיָּשִׂימוּ עַל־שְׁכֶם שְׁנֵיהֶם וַיֵּלְכוּ אֲחֹרַנִּית וַיְכַסּוּ אֵת עֶרְוַת אֲבִיהֶם וּפְנֵיהֶם אֲחֹרַנִּית וְעֶרְוַת אֲבִיהֶם לֹא רָאוּ׃
וּנְסִיב שֵׁם וְיֶפֶת יָת כְּסוּתָא וְשַׁוִיו עַל כְּתַף תַּרְוֵיהוֹן וַאֲזָלוּ מְחַזְּרִין וַחֲפִיאוּ יָת עֶרְיָתָא דַּאֲבוּהוֹן וְאַפֵּיהוֹן מְחַזְּרִין וְעֶרְיָתָא דַּאֲבוּהוֹן לָא חָזוֹ׃

Genesis 9:24 · ×2

וַיִּיקֶץ נֹחַ מִיֵּינוֹ וַיֵּדַע אֵת אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה לוֹ בְּנוֹ הַקָּטָן׃
וַיִּיקֶץ נֹחַ מִיֵּינוֹ וַיֵּדַע אֵת אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה לוֹ בְּנוֹ הַקָּטָן׃
וְאִתְעַר נֹחַ מֵחַמְרֵיהּ וִידַע יָת דִּי עֲבַד לֵיהּ בְּרֵיהּ זְעֵירָא׃

Genesis 9:25 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר אָרוּר כְּנָעַן עֶבֶד עֲבָדִים יִהְיֶה לְאֶחָיו׃
וַיֹּאמֶר אָרוּר כְּנָעַן עֶבֶד עֲבָדִים יִהְיֶה לְאֶחָיו׃
וַאֲמַר לֵיט כְּנָעַן עֶבֶד פָּלַח עַבְדִין יְהֵי לַאֲחוֹהִי׃

Genesis 9:26 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹקֵי שֵׁם וִיהִי כְנַעַן עֶבֶד לָמוֹ׃
וַיֹּאמֶר בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹקֵי שֵׁם וִיהִי כְנַעַן עֶבֶד לָמוֹ׃
וַאֲמַר בְּרִיךְ יְיָ אֱלָהֵהּ דְּשֵׁם וִיהֵי כְנַעַן עַבְדָא לְהוֹן׃

Genesis 9:27 · ×2

יַפְתְּ אֱלֹקִים לְיֶפֶת וְיִשְׁכֹּן בְּאָהֳלֵי־שֵׁם וִיהִי כְנַעַן עֶבֶד לָמוֹ׃
יַפְתְּ אֱלֹקִים לְיֶפֶת וְיִשְׁכֹּן בְּאָהֳלֵי־שֵׁם וִיהִי כְנַעַן עֶבֶד לָמוֹ׃
יַפְתֵּי יְיָ לְיֶפֶת וְיִשְׁרֵי שְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ בְּמַשְׁכְּנֵיהּ דְּשֵׁם וִיהֵי כְנַעַן עַבְדָא לְהוֹן׃

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שנה שנין

Genesis 9:28 · ×2

וַיְחִי־נֹחַ אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וְחֲמִשִּׁים שָׁנָה׃
וַיְחִי־נֹחַ אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וְחֲמִשִּׁים שָׁנָה׃
וַחֲיָא נֹחַ בָּתַר טוֹפָנָא תְּלַת מְאָה וְחַמְשִׁין שְׁנִין׃

Genesis 9:29 · ×2

וַיְהִיוּ*(בספרי ספרד ואשכנז וַיִּהְיוּ) כָּל־יְמֵי־נֹחַ תְּשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַחֲמִשִּׁים שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַיְהִיוּ*(בספרי ספרד ואשכנז וַיִּהְיוּ) כָּל־יְמֵי־נֹחַ תְּשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַחֲמִשִּׁים שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַהֲווֹ כָּל יוֹמֵי נֹחַ תְּשַׁע מְאָה וְחַמְשִׁין שְׁנִין וּמִית׃

ויולד בנים

Genesis 10:1 · ×2

וְאֵלֶּה תּוֹלְדֹת בְּנֵי־נֹחַ שֵׁם חָם וָיֶפֶת וַיִּוָּלְדוּ לָהֶם בָּנִים אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל׃
וְאֵלֶּה תּוֹלְדֹת בְּנֵי־נֹחַ שֵׁם חָם וָיֶפֶת וַיִּוָּלְדוּ לָהֶם בָּנִים אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל׃
וְאִלֵּין תּוֹלְדַת בְּנֵי נֹחַ שֵׁם חָם וְיָפֶת וְאִתְיְלִידוּ לְהוֹן בְּנִין בָּתַר טוֹפָנָא׃

Genesis 10:2 · ×2

בְּנֵי יֶפֶת גֹּמֶר וּמָגוֹג וּמָדַי וְיָוָן וְתֻבַל וּמֶשֶׁךְ וְתִירָס׃
בְּנֵי יֶפֶת גֹּמֶר וּמָגוֹג וּמָדַי וְיָוָן וְתֻבַל וּמֶשֶׁךְ וְתִירָס׃
בְּנֵי יֶפֶת גּוֹמַר וּמָגוֹג וּמָדַי וְיָוָן וְתוּבָל וּמֶשֶׁךְ וְתִירָס׃

Genesis 10:3 · ×2

וּבְנֵי גֹמֶר אַשְׁכְּנַז וְרִיפַת וְתֹגַרְמָה׃
וּבְנֵי גֹמֶר אַשְׁכְּנַז וְרִיפַת וְתֹגַרְמָה׃
וּבְנֵי גוֹמַר אַשְׁכְּנַז וְרִיפַת וְתוֹגַרְמָה׃

Genesis 10:4 · ×2

וּבְנֵי יָוָן אֱלִישָׁה וְתַרְשִׁישׁ כִּתִּים וְדֹדָנִים׃
וּבְנֵי יָוָן אֱלִישָׁה וְתַרְשִׁישׁ כִּתִּים וְדֹדָנִים׃
וּבְנֵי יָוָן אֱלִישָׁה וְתַרְשִׁישׁ כִּתִּים וְדֹדָנִים׃

Genesis 10:5 · ×2

מֵאֵלֶּה נִפְרְדוּ אִיֵּי הַגּוֹיִם בְּאַרְצֹתָם אִישׁ לִלְשֹׁנוֹ לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם בְּגוֹיֵהֶם׃
מֵאֵלֶּה נִפְרְדוּ אִיֵּי הַגּוֹיִם בְּאַרְצֹתָם אִישׁ לִלְשֹׁנוֹ לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם בְּגוֹיֵהֶם׃
מֵאִלֵּין אִתַּפְרָשׁוּ נָגְוָת עַמְמַיָּא בְּאַרְעָהוֹן גְּבַר לְלִישָׁנֵיהּ לְזַרְעֲיָתְהוֹן בְּעַמְמֵיהוֹן׃

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Genesis 10:6 · ×2

וּבְנֵי חָם כּוּשׁ וּמִצְרַיִם וּפוּט וּכְנָעַן׃
וּבְנֵי חָם כּוּשׁ וּמִצְרַיִם וּפוּט וּכְנָעַן׃
וּבְנֵי חָם כּוּשׁ וּמִצְרַיִם וּפוּט וּכְנָעַן׃

Genesis 10:7 · ×2

וּבְנֵי כוּשׁ סְבָא וְחֲוִילָה וְסַבְתָּה וְרַעְמָה וְסַבְתְּכָא וּבְנֵי רַעְמָה שְׁבָא וּדְדָן׃
וּבְנֵי כוּשׁ סְבָא וְחֲוִילָה וְסַבְתָּה וְרַעְמָה וְסַבְתְּכָא וּבְנֵי רַעְמָה שְׁבָא וּדְדָן׃
וּבְנֵי כוּשׁ סְבָא וַחֲוִילָה וְסַבְתָּה וְרַעְמָה וְסַבְתְּכָא וּבְנֵי רַעְמָה שְׁבָא וּדְדָן׃

Genesis 10:8 · ×2

וְכוּשׁ יָלַד אֶת־נִמְרֹד הוּא הֵחֵל לִהְיוֹת גִּבֹּר בָּאָרֶץ׃
וְכוּשׁ יָלַד אֶת־נִמְרֹד הוּא הֵחֵל לִהְיוֹת גִּבֹּר בָּאָרֶץ׃
וְכוּשׁ אוֹלִיד יָת נִמְרֹד הוּא שָׁרֵי לְמֶהֱוֵי גִּבַּר תַּקִּיף בְּאַרְעָא׃

Genesis 10:9 · ×2

הוּא־הָיָה גִבֹּר־צַיִד לִפְנֵי יְהוָה עַל־כֵּן יֵאָמַר כְּנִמְרֹד גִּבּוֹר צַיִד לִפְנֵי יְהוָה׃
הוּא־הָיָה גִבֹּר־צַיִד לִפְנֵי יְהוָה עַל־כֵּן יֵאָמַר כְּנִמְרֹד גִּבּוֹר צַיִד לִפְנֵי יְהוָה׃
הוּא הֲוָה גִּבַּר תַּקִּיף קֳדָם יְיָ עַל כֵּן יִתְאֲמַר כְּנִמְרֹד גִּבַּר תַּקִּיף קֳדָם יְיָ׃

Genesis 10:10 · ×2

וַתְּהִי רֵאשִׁית מַמְלַכְתּוֹ בָּבֶל וְאֶרֶךְ וְאַכַּד וְכַלְנֵה בְּאֶרֶץ שִׁנְעָר׃
וַתְּהִי רֵאשִׁית מַמְלַכְתּוֹ בָּבֶל וְאֶרֶךְ וְאַכַּד וְכַלְנֵה בְּאֶרֶץ שִׁנְעָר׃
וַהֲוָה רֵישׁ מַלְכוּתֵיהּ בָּבֶל וְאֶרֶךְ וְאַכַּד וְכַלְנֵה בְּאַרְעָא דְבָבֶל׃

Genesis 10:11 · ×2

מִן־הָאָרֶץ הַהִוא יָצָא אַשּׁוּר וַיִּבֶן אֶת־נִינְוֵה וְאֶת־רְחֹבֹת עִיר וְאֶת־כָּלַח׃
מִן־הָאָרֶץ הַהִוא יָצָא אַשּׁוּר וַיִּבֶן אֶת־נִינְוֵה וְאֶת־רְחֹבֹת עִיר וְאֶת־כָּלַח׃
מִן אַרְעָא (נ"א עֵיצָה) הַהִיא נְפַק אָתוּרָאָה וּבְנָא יָת נִינְוֵה וְיָת רְחֹבֹת (נ"א רְחוֹבֵי) קַרְתָּא וְיָת כָּלַח׃

Genesis 10:12 · ×2

וְאֶת־רֶסֶן בֵּין נִינְוֵה וּבֵין כָּלַח הִוא הָעִיר הַגְּדֹלָה׃
וְאֶת־רֶסֶן בֵּין נִינְוֵה וּבֵין כָּלַח הִוא הָעִיר הַגְּדֹלָה׃
וְיָת רֶסֶן בֵּין נִינְוֵה וּבֵין כָּלַח הִיא קַרְתָּא רַבְּתָא׃

Genesis 10:13 · ×2

וּמִצְרַיִם יָלַד אֶת־לוּדִים וְאֶת־עֲנָמִים וְאֶת־לְהָבִים וְאֶת־נַפְתֻּחִים׃
וּמִצְרַיִם יָלַד אֶת־לוּדִים וְאֶת־עֲנָמִים וְאֶת־לְהָבִים וְאֶת־נַפְתֻּחִים׃
וּמִצְרָאֵי (נ"א וּמִצְרַיִם) אוֹלִיד יָת לוּדָאֵי וְיָת עֲנָמָאֵי וְיָת לְהָבָאֵי וְיָת נַפְתּוּחָאֵי׃

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Genesis 10:14 · ×2

וְאֶת־פַּתְרֻסִּים וְאֶת־כַּסְלֻחִים אֲשֶׁר יָצְאוּ מִשָּׁם פְּלִשְׁתִּים וְאֶת־כַּפְתֹּרִים׃
וְאֶת־פַּתְרֻסִּים וְאֶת־כַּסְלֻחִים אֲשֶׁר יָצְאוּ מִשָּׁם פְּלִשְׁתִּים וְאֶת־כַּפְתֹּרִים׃
וְיָת פַּתְרוֹסָאֵי וְיָת כַּסְלוּחָאֵי דִּי נְפָקוּ מִתַּמָּן פְּלִשְׁתָּאֵי וְיָת קַפּוּטְקָאֵי׃

Genesis 10:15 · ×2

וּכְנַעַן יָלַד אֶת־צִידֹן בְּכֹרוֹ וְאֶת־חֵת׃
וּכְנַעַן יָלַד אֶת־צִידֹן בְּכֹרוֹ וְאֶת־חֵת׃
וּכְנַעַן אוֹלִיד יָת צִידוֹן בֻּכְרֵיהּ וְיָת חֵת׃

Genesis 10:16 · ×2

וְאֶת־הַיְבוּסִי וְאֶת־הָאֱמֹרִי וְאֶת הַגִּרְגָּשִׁי׃
וְאֶת־הַיְבוּסִי וְאֶת־הָאֱמֹרִי וְאֶת הַגִּרְגָּשִׁי׃
וְיָת יְבוּסָאֵי וְיָת אֱמוֹרָאֵי וְיָת גִּרְגָּשָׁאֵי׃

Genesis 10:17 · ×2

וְאֶת־הַחִוִּי וְאֶת־הָעַרְקִי וְאֶת־הַסִּינִי׃
וְאֶת־הַחִוִּי וְאֶת־הָעַרְקִי וְאֶת־הַסִּינִי׃
וְיָת חִוָּאֵי וְיָת עַרְקָאֵי וְיָת אַנְתּוֹסָאֵי׃

Genesis 10:18 · ×2

וְאֶת־הָאַרְוָדִי וְאֶת־הַצְּמָרִי וְאֶת־הַחֲמָתִי וְאַחַר נָפֹצוּ מִשְׁפְּחוֹת הַכְּנַעֲנִי׃
וְאֶת־הָאַרְוָדִי וְאֶת־הַצְּמָרִי וְאֶת־הַחֲמָתִי וְאַחַר נָפֹצוּ מִשְׁפְּחוֹת הַכְּנַעֲנִי׃
וְיָת אַרְוָדָאֵי וְיָת צְמָרָאֵי וְיָת חֲמָתָאֵי וּבָתַר כֵּן אִתְבַּדָּרוּ זַרְעֲיַת כְּנַעֲנָאֵי׃

Genesis 10:19 · ×2

וַיְהִי גְּבוּל הַכְּנַעֲנִי מִצִּידֹן בֹּאֲכָה גְרָרָה עַד־עַזָּה בֹּאֲכָה סְדֹמָה וַעֲמֹרָה וְאַדְמָה וּצְבֹיִם עַד־לָשַׁע׃
וַיְהִי גְּבוּל הַכְּנַעֲנִי מִצִּידֹן בֹּאֲכָה גְרָרָה עַד־עַזָּה בֹּאֲכָה סְדֹמָה וַעֲמֹרָה וְאַדְמָה וּצְבֹיִם עַד־לָשַׁע׃
וַהֲוָה תְּחוּם כְּנַעֲנָאֵי מִצִּידוֹן מָטֵי לְגֶרַר עַד עַזָּה מָטֵי לְסְדוֹם וַעֲמוֹרָה וְאַדְמָה וּצְבוֹיִם עַד לָשַׁע׃

Genesis 10:20 · ×2

אֵלֶּה בְנֵי־חָם לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם לִלְשֹׁנֹתָם בְּאַרְצֹתָם בְּגוֹיֵהֶם׃
אֵלֶּה בְנֵי־חָם לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם לִלְשֹׁנֹתָם בְּאַרְצֹתָם בְּגוֹיֵהֶם׃
אִלֵּין בְּנֵי חָם לְזַרְעֲיָתְהוֹן לְלִישָׁנְהוֹן בְּאַרְעָתְהוֹן בְּעַמְמֵיהוֹן׃

Genesis 10:21 · ×2

וּלְשֵׁם יֻלַּד גַּם־הוּא אֲבִי כָּל־בְּנֵי־עֵבֶר אֲחִי יֶפֶת הַגָּדוֹל׃
וּלְשֵׁם יֻלַּד גַּם־הוּא אֲבִי כָּל־בְּנֵי־עֵבֶר אֲחִי יֶפֶת הַגָּדוֹל׃
וּלְשֵׁם אִתְיְלִיד אַף הוּא אֲבוּהוֹן דְּכָל בְּנֵי עֵבֶר אֲחוּהִי דְּיֶפֶת רַבָּא׃

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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Genesis 10:22 · ×2

בְּנֵי שֵׁם עֵילָם וְאַשּׁוּר וְאַרְפַּכְשַׁד וְלוּד וָאֲרָם׃
בְּנֵי שֵׁם עֵילָם וְאַשּׁוּר וְאַרְפַּכְשַׁד וְלוּד וָאֲרָם׃
בְּנֵי שֵׁם עֵילָם וְאַשּׁוּר וְאַרְפַּכְשַׁד וְלוּד וַאֲרָם׃

Genesis 10:23 · ×2

וּבְנֵי אֲרָם עוּץ וְחוּל וְגֶתֶר וָמָשׁ׃
וּבְנֵי אֲרָם עוּץ וְחוּל וְגֶתֶר וָמָשׁ׃
וּבְנֵי אֲרָם עוּץ וְחוּל וְגֶתֶר וָמַשׁ׃

Genesis 10:24 · ×2

וְאַרְפַּכְשַׁד יָלַד אֶת־שָׁלַח וְשֶׁלַח יָלַד אֶת־עֵבֶר׃
וְאַרְפַּכְשַׁד יָלַד אֶת־שָׁלַח וְשֶׁלַח יָלַד אֶת־עֵבֶר׃
וְאַרְפַּכְשַׁד אוֹלִיד יָת שָׁלַח וְשֶׁלַח אוֹלִיד יָת עֵבֶר׃

Genesis 10:25 · ×2

וּלְעֵבֶר יֻלַּד שְׁנֵי בָנִים שֵׁם הָאֶחָד פֶּלֶג כִּי בְיָמָיו נִפְלְגָה הָאָרֶץ וְשֵׁם אָחִיו יָקְטָן׃
וּלְעֵבֶר יֻלַּד שְׁנֵי בָנִים שֵׁם הָאֶחָד פֶּלֶג כִּי בְיָמָיו נִפְלְגָה הָאָרֶץ וְשֵׁם אָחִיו יָקְטָן׃
וּלְעֵבֶר אִתְיְלִידוּ תְּרֵין בְּנִין שׁוּם חַד פֶּלֶג אֲרֵי בְּיוֹמוֹהִי אִתְפְּלִיגַת אַרְעָא וְשׁוּם אֲחוּהִי יָקְטָן׃

Genesis 10:26 · ×2

וְיָקְטָן יָלַד אֶת־אַלְמוֹדָד וְאֶת־שָׁלֶף וְאֶת־חֲצַרְמָוֶת וְאֶת־יָרַח׃
וְיָקְטָן יָלַד אֶת־אַלְמוֹדָד וְאֶת־שָׁלֶף וְאֶת־חֲצַרְמָוֶת וְאֶת־יָרַח׃
וְיָקְטָן אוֹלִיד יָת אַלְמוֹדָד וְיָת שָׁלֶף וְיָת חֲצַרְמָוֶת וְיָת יָרַח׃

Genesis 10:27 · ×2

וְאֶת־הֲדוֹרָם וְאֶת־אוּזָל וְאֶת־דִּקְלָה׃
וְאֶת־הֲדוֹרָם וְאֶת־אוּזָל וְאֶת־דִּקְלָה׃
וְיָת הֲדוֹרָם וְיָת אוּזָל וְיָת דִּקְלָה׃

Genesis 10:28 · ×2

וְאֶת־עוֹבָל וְאֶת־אֲבִימָאֵל וְאֶת־שְׁבָא׃
וְאֶת־עוֹבָל וְאֶת־אֲבִימָאֵל וְאֶת־שְׁבָא׃
וְיָת עוֹבָל וְיָת אֲבִימָאֵל וְיָת שְׁבָא׃

Genesis 10:29 · ×2

וְאֶת־אוֹפִר וְאֶת־חֲוִילָה וְאֶת־יוֹבָב כָּל־אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי יָקְטָן׃
וְאֶת־אוֹפִר וְאֶת־חֲוִילָה וְאֶת־יוֹבָב כָּל־אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי יָקְטָן׃
וְיָת אוֹפִר וְיָת חֲוִילָה וְיָת יוֹבָב כָּל אִלֵּין בְּנֵי יָקְטָן׃

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

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Friday, 16 October 2026 · Aliyah 6+7/7 (Genesis 9:18–11:32) · Daf Bekhorot 28

Genesis 10:30 · ×2

וַיְהִי מוֹשָׁבָם מִמֵּשָׁא בֹּאֲכָה סְפָרָה הַר הַקֶּדֶם׃
וַיְהִי מוֹשָׁבָם מִמֵּשָׁא בֹּאֲכָה סְפָרָה הַר הַקֶּדֶם׃
וַהֲוָה מוֹתָבְנְהוֹן מִמֵּשָׁא מָטֵי לְסַפַּר טוּר מָדִינְחָא׃

Genesis 10:31 · ×2

אֵלֶּה בְנֵי־שֵׁם לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם לִלְשֹׁנֹתָם בְּאַרְצֹתָם לְגוֹיֵהֶם׃
אֵלֶּה בְנֵי־שֵׁם לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם לִלְשֹׁנֹתָם בְּאַרְצֹתָם לְגוֹיֵהֶם׃
אִלֵּין בְּנֵי שֵׁם לְזַרְעֲיָתְהוֹן לְלִישָׁנְהוֹן לְאַרְעָתְהוֹן בְּעַמְמֵיהוֹן׃

Genesis 10:32 · ×2

אֵלֶּה מִשְׁפְּחֹת בְּנֵי־נֹחַ לְתוֹלְדֹתָם בְּגוֹיֵהֶם וּמֵאֵלֶּה נִפְרְדוּ הַגּוֹיִם בָּאָרֶץ אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל׃
אֵלֶּה מִשְׁפְּחֹת בְּנֵי־נֹחַ לְתוֹלְדֹתָם בְּגוֹיֵהֶם וּמֵאֵלֶּה נִפְרְדוּ הַגּוֹיִם בָּאָרֶץ אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל׃
אִלֵּין זַרְעַיַת בְּנֵי נֹחַ לְתוּלְדָתְהוֹן בְּעַמְמֵיהוֹן וּמֵאִלֵּין אִתְפְּרָשׁוּ עַמְמַיָּא בְּאַרְעָא בָּתַר טוֹפָנָא׃

Genesis 11:1 · ×2

וַיְהִי כָל־הָאָרֶץ שָׂפָה אֶחָת וּדְבָרִים אֲחָדִים׃
וַיְהִי כָל־הָאָרֶץ שָׂפָה אֶחָת וּדְבָרִים אֲחָדִים׃
וַהֲוָה כָל אַרְעָא לִישָׁן חַד וּמַמְלַל חַד׃

Genesis 11:2 · ×2

וַיְהִי בְּנָסְעָם מִקֶּדֶם וַיִּמְצְאוּ בִקְעָה בְּאֶרֶץ שִׁנְעָר וַיֵּשְׁבוּ שָׁם׃
וַיְהִי בְּנָסְעָם מִקֶּדֶם וַיִּמְצְאוּ בִקְעָה בְּאֶרֶץ שִׁנְעָר וַיֵּשְׁבוּ שָׁם׃
וַהֲוָה בְּמִטַּלְהוֹן בְּקִדְמֵיתָא וְאַשְׁכָּחוּ בִּקְעָתָא בְּאַרְעָא דְּבָבֶל וִיתִיבוּ תַּמָּן׃

Genesis 11:3 · ×2

וַיֹּאמְרוּ אִישׁ אֶל־רֵעֵהוּ הָבָה נִלְבְּנָה לְבֵנִים וְנִשְׂרְפָה לִשְׂרֵפָה וַתְּהִי לָהֶם הַלְּבֵנָה לְאָבֶן וְהַחֵמָר הָיָה לָהֶם לַחֹמֶר׃
וַיֹּאמְרוּ אִישׁ אֶל־רֵעֵהוּ הָבָה נִלְבְּנָה לְבֵנִים וְנִשְׂרְפָה לִשְׂרֵפָה וַתְּהִי לָהֶם הַלְּבֵנָה לְאָבֶן וְהַחֵמָר הָיָה לָהֶם לַחֹמֶר׃
וַאֲמָרוּ גְּבַר לְחַבְרֵיהּ הָבוּ נִרְמֵי לִבְנִין וְנִשְׂרְפִנּוּן בְּנוּרָא (יוֹקַדְתָּא) וַהֲוַת לְהוֹן לְבֵנְתָּא לְאַבְנָא וְחֵימְרָא הֲוָה לְהוֹן לְשִׁיעַ׃

Genesis 11:4 · ×2

וַיֹּאמְרוּ הָבָה | נִבְנֶה־לָּנוּ עִיר וּמִגְדָּל וְרֹאשׁוֹ בַּשָּׁמַיִם וְנַעֲשֶׂה־לָּנוּ שֵׁם פֶּן־נָפוּץ עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַיֹּאמְרוּ הָבָה | נִבְנֶה־לָּנוּ עִיר וּמִגְדָּל וְרֹאשׁוֹ בַּשָּׁמַיִם וְנַעֲשֶׂה־לָּנוּ שֵׁם פֶּן־נָפוּץ עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַאֲמָרוּ הָבוּ נִבְנֵי לָנָא קַרְתָּא וּמַגְדְּלָא וְרֵישֵׁיהּ מָטֵי עַד צֵית שְׁמַיָּא וְנַעְבֵּיד לָנָא שׁוּם דְּיִלְמָא נִתְבַּדַּר עַל אַפֵּי כָל אַרְעָא׃

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Genesis 11:5 · ×2

וַיֵּרֶד יְהוָה לִרְאֹת אֶת־הָעִיר וְאֶת־הַמִּגְדֶּל אֲשֶׁר בָּנוּ בְּנֵי הָאָדָם׃
וַיֵּרֶד יְהוָה לִרְאֹת אֶת־הָעִיר וְאֶת־הַמִּגְדֶּל אֲשֶׁר בָּנוּ בְּנֵי הָאָדָם׃
וְאִתְגְּלִי יְיָ לְאִתְפָּרָעָא עַל עוֹבָדֵי קַרְתָּא וּמַגְדְּלָא דִּי בְנוֹ בְּנֵי אֱנָשָׁא׃

Genesis 11:6 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה הֵן עַם אֶחָד וְשָׂפָה אַחַת לְכֻלָּם וְזֶה הַחִלָּם לַעֲשׂוֹת וְעַתָּה לֹא־יִבָּצֵר מֵהֶם כֹּל אֲשֶׁר יָזְמוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת׃
וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה הֵן עַם אֶחָד וְשָׂפָה אַחַת לְכֻלָּם וְזֶה הַחִלָּם לַעֲשׂוֹת וְעַתָּה לֹא־יִבָּצֵר מֵהֶם כֹּל אֲשֶׁר יָזְמוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ הָא עַמָּא חַד וְלִישָׁן חַד לְכֻלְּהוֹן וְדֵין דְּשָׁרִיו לְמֶעְבַּד וּכְעַן לָא יִתְמְנַע מִנְּהוֹן כֹּל דְּחַשִּׁיבוּ לְמֶעְבַּד׃

Genesis 11:7 · ×2

הָבָה נָרְדָה וְנָבְלָה שָׁם שְׂפָתָם אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִשְׁמְעוּ אִישׁ שְׂפַת רֵעֵהוּ׃
הָבָה נָרְדָה וְנָבְלָה שָׁם שְׂפָתָם אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִשְׁמְעוּ אִישׁ שְׂפַת רֵעֵהוּ׃
הָבוּ נִתְגְּלִי וּנְבַלְבֵּל תַּמָּן לִישָׁנְהוֹן דְּלָא יִשְׁמְעוּן אֱנַשׁ (גְּבַר) לִישַׁן חַבְרֵיהּ׃

Genesis 11:8 · ×2

וַיָּפֶץ יְהוָה אֹתָם מִשָּׁם עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ וַיַּחְדְּלוּ לִבְנֹת הָעִיר׃
וַיָּפֶץ יְהוָה אֹתָם מִשָּׁם עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ וַיַּחְדְּלוּ לִבְנֹת הָעִיר׃
וּבַדַּר יְיָ יָתְהוֹן מִתַּמָּן עַל אַפֵּי כָל אַרְעָא וּמְנָעוּ לְמִבְנֵי (נ"י וְאִתְמְנָעוּ מִלְּמִבְנֵי) קַרְתָּא׃

Genesis 11:9 · ×2

עַל־כֵּן קָרָא שְׁמָהּ בָּבֶל כִּי־שָׁם בָּלַל יְהוָה שְׂפַת כָּל־הָאָרֶץ וּמִשָּׁם הֱפִיצָם יְהוָה עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ׃
עַל־כֵּן קָרָא שְׁמָהּ בָּבֶל כִּי־שָׁם בָּלַל יְהוָה שְׂפַת כָּל־הָאָרֶץ וּמִשָּׁם הֱפִיצָם יְהוָה עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ׃
עַל כֵּן קְרָא שְׁמַהּ בָּבֶל אֲרֵי תַּמָּן בַּלְבֵּל יְיָ לִישַׁן כָּל אַרְעָא וּמִתַּמָּן בַּדְּרִנּוּן יְיָ עַל אַפֵּי כָּל אַרְעָא׃

ואוליד

Genesis 11:10 · ×2

אֵלֶּה תּוֹלְדֹת שֵׁם שֵׁם בֶּן־מְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־אַרְפַּכְשַׁד שְׁנָתַיִם אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל׃
אֵלֶּה תּוֹלְדֹת שֵׁם שֵׁם בֶּן־מְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־אַרְפַּכְשַׁד שְׁנָתַיִם אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל׃
אִלֵּין תּוּלְדַת שֵׁם שֵׁם בַּר מְאָה שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת אַרְפַּכְשַׁד תַּרְתֵּין שְׁנִין בָּתַר טוֹפָנָא׃

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and skylights, warnings and wonders — a reader for Friday and Shabbat

Friday, 16 October 2026 · Aliyah 6+7/7 (Genesis 9:18–11:32) · Daf Bekhorot 28

Genesis 11:11 · ×2

וַיְחִי־שֵׁם אָחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֣ אֶת־אַרְפַּכְשָׁ֔ד חֲמֵ֥שׁ מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַיְחִי־שֵׁם אָחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֣ אֶת־אַרְפַּכְשָׁ֔ד חֲמֵ֥שׁ מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא שֵׁם בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת אַרְפַּכְשָׁד חֲמֵשׁ מְאָה שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 11:12 · ×2

וְאַרְפַּכְשַׁ֕ד חַ֥י חֲמֵ֖שׁ וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֖וֹלֶד אֶת־שָֽׁלַח׃
וְאַרְפַּכְשַׁ֕ד חַ֥י חֲמֵ֖שׁ וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֖וֹלֶד אֶת־שָֽׁלַח׃
וְאַרְפַּכְשַׁד חֲיָא תְּלָתִין וַחֲמֵשׁ שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת שֶׁלַח׃

Genesis 11:13 · ×2

וַיְחִ֣י אַרְפַּכְשַׁ֗ד אַחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֣ אֶת־שֶׁ֔לַח שָׁלֹ֥שׁ שָׁנִ֖ים וְאַרְבַּ֣ע מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַיְחִ֣י אַרְפַּכְשַׁ֗ד אַחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֣ אֶת־שֶׁ֔לַח שָׁלֹ֥שׁ שָׁנִ֖ים וְאַרְבַּ֣ע מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא אַרְפַּכְשַׁד בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת שֶׁלַח תְּלָת שְׁנִין וְאַרְבַּע מְאָה וּתְלָת שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 11:14 · ×2

וְשֶׁ֖לַח חַ֣י שְׁלֹשִׁ֑ים שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֖וֹלֶד אֶת־עֵֽבֶר׃
וְשֶׁ֖לַח חַ֣י שְׁלֹשִׁ֑ים שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֖וֹלֶד אֶת־עֵֽבֶר׃
וְשֶׁלַח חֲיָא תְּלָתִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת עֵבֶר׃

Genesis 11:15 · ×2

וַיְחִי־שֶׁ֗לַח אַחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֣ אֶת־עֵ֔בֶר שָׁלֹ֥שׁ שָׁנִ֖ים וְאַרְבַּ֣ע מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַיְחִי־שֶׁ֗לַח אַחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֣ אֶת־עֵ֔בֶר שָׁלֹ֥שׁ שָׁנִ֖ים וְאַרְבַּ֣ע מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא שֶׁלַח בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת עֵבֶר אַרְבַּע מְאָה וּתְלָת שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 11:16 · ×2

וְעֵ֖בֶר אַרְבַּ֣ע וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֑ים שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֖וֹלֶד אֶת־פָּֽלֶג׃
וְעֵ֖בֶר אַרְבַּ֣ע וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֑ים שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֖וֹלֶד אֶת־פָּֽלֶג׃
וַחֲיָא עֵבֶר תְּלָתִין וְאַרְבַּע שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת פָּלֶג׃

Genesis 11:17 · ×2

וַיְחִי־עֵ֗בֶר אַחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֣ אֶת־פֶּ֔לֶג שְׁלֹשִׁ֥ים שָׁנָ֖ה וְאַרְבַּ֣ע מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַיְחִי־עֵ֗בֶר אַחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֣ אֶת־פֶּ֔לֶג שְׁלֹשִׁ֥ים שָׁנָ֖ה וְאַרְבַּ֣ע מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא עֵבֶר בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת פֶּלֶג אַרְבַּע מְאָה וּתְלָתִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 11:18 · ×2

וְפֶ֖לֶג שְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֖וֹלֶד אֶת־רְעֽוּ׃
וְפֶ֖לֶג שְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֖וֹלֶד אֶת־רְעֽוּ׃
וַחֲיָא פֶּלֶג תְּלָתִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת רְעוּ׃

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Friday, 16 October 2026 · Aliyah 6+7/7 (Genesis 9:18–11:32) · Daf Bekhorot 28

Genesis 11:19 · ×2

וַיְחִי־פֶלֶג אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־רְעוּ תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וּמָאתַיִם שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַיְחִי־פֶלֶג אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־רְעוּ תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וּמָאתַיִם שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא פֶלֶג בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת רְעוּ מָאתָן וּתְשַׁע שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 11:20 · ×2

וַיְחִי רְעוּ שְׁתַּיִם וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־שְׂרוּג׃
וַיְחִי רְעוּ שְׁתַּיִם וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־שְׂרוּג׃
וַחֲיָא רְעוּ תְּלָתִין וְתַרְתֵּין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת שְׂרוּג׃

Genesis 11:21 · ×2

וַיְחִי רְעוּ אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־שְׂרוּג שָׁבַע שָׁנִים וּמָאתַיִם שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַיְחִי רְעוּ אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־שְׂרוּג שָׁבַע שָׁנִים וּמָאתַיִם שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא רְעוּ בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת שְׂרוּג מָאתָן וּשְׁבַע שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 11:22 · ×2

וַיְחִי שְׂרוּג שְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־נָחוֹר׃
וַיְחִי שְׂרוּג שְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־נָחוֹר׃
וַחֲיָא שְׂרוּג תְּלָתִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת נָחוֹר׃

Genesis 11:23 · ×2

וַיְחִי שְׂרוּג אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־נָחוֹר מָאתַיִם שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַיְחִי שְׂרוּג אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־נָחוֹר מָאתַיִם שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא שְׂרוּג בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת נָחוֹר מָאתָן שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 11:24 · ×2

וַיְחִי נָחוֹר תֵּשַׁע וְעֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־תָּרַח׃
וַיְחִי נָחוֹר תֵּשַׁע וְעֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־תָּרַח׃
וַחֲיָא נָחוֹר עֶשְׂרִין וּתְשַׁע שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת תָּרַח׃

Genesis 11:25 · ×2

וַיְחִי נָחוֹר אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־תָּרַח תְּשַׁע־עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַיְחִי נָחוֹר אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־תָּרַח תְּשַׁע־עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא נָחוֹר בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת תָּרַח מְאָה וּתְשַׁע עֲשַׂר שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 11:26 · ×2

וַיְחִי־תֶרַח שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־אַבְרָם אֶת־נָחוֹר וְאֶת־הָרָן׃
וַיְחִי־תֶרַח שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־אַבְרָם אֶת־נָחוֹר וְאֶת־הָרָן׃
וַחֲיָא תֶרַח שִׁבְעִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת אַבְרָם יָת נָחוֹר וְיָת הָרָן׃

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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Genesis 11:27 · ×2

וְאֵלֶּה֙ תּוֹלְדֹ֣ת תֶּ֔רַח תֶּ֖רַח הוֹלִ֣יד אֶת־אַבְרָ֑ם אֶת־נָחֹ֥ור וְאֶת־הָרָ֖ן וְהָרָ֥ן הוֹלִ֖יד אֶת־לֹֽוט׃
וְאֵלֶּה֙ תּוֹלְדֹ֣ת תֶּ֔רַח תֶּ֖רַח הוֹלִ֣יד אֶת־אַבְרָ֑ם אֶת־נָחֹ֥ור וְאֶת־הָרָ֖ן וְהָרָ֥ן הוֹלִ֖יד אֶת־לֹֽוט׃
וְאִלֵּין תּוּלְדַת֙ תֶּ֔רַח תֶּ֖רַח אוֹלִ֣יד יָת֑ אַבְרָם֙ יָ֣ת נָחֹ֔ור וְיָ֖ת הָרָ֥ן וְהָרָ֛ן אוֹלִ֥יד יָת֖ לוֹֽט׃

Genesis 11:28 · ×2

וַיָּ֥מָת הָרָ֖ן עַל־פְּנֵ֣י תֶּ֑רַח אָבִ֔יו בְּאֶ֖רֶץ מֹולַדְתֹּ֥ו בְּאֻ֛ור כַּשְׂדִּֽים׃
וַיָּ֥מָת הָרָ֖ן עַל־פְּנֵ֣י תֶּ֑רַח אָבִ֔יו בְּאֶ֖רֶץ מֹולַדְתֹּ֥ו בְּאֻ֛ור כַּשְׂדִּֽים׃
וּמִית הָרָן֙ עַ֣ל אַפֵּ֔י תֶּ֖רַח אֲבוּהִ֑י בְּאַרְעָ֗א דְיַלְּדוּתֵ֛יהּ בְּאוּר֥ דְּכַסְדָּאֵֽי׃

Genesis 11:29 · ×2

וַיִּקַּ֨ח אַבְרָ֜ם וְנָחֹ֗ור לָהֶם֙ נָשִׁ֔ים שֵׁ֚ם אֵ֣שֶׁת־אַבְרָ֔ם שָׂרָ֑י וְשֵׁם֙ אֵ֣שֶׁת־נָחֹ֔ור מִלְכָּ֖ה בַּת־הָרָ֣ן אֲבִי־מִלְכָּ֑ה וַאֲבִ֖י יִסְכָּֽה׃
וַיִּקַּ֨ח אַבְרָ֜ם וְנָחֹ֗ור לָהֶם֙ נָשִׁ֔ים שֵׁ֚ם אֵ֣שֶׁת־אַבְרָ֔ם שָׂרָ֑י וְשֵׁם֙ אֵ֣שֶׁת־נָחֹ֔ור מִלְכָּ֖ה בַּת־הָרָ֣ן אֲבִי־מִלְכָּ֑ה וַאֲבִ֖י יִסְכָּֽה׃
וּנְסִיב אַבְרָם֙ וְנָחוֹר֙ לְהוֹן֙ נְשִׁ֔ין שׁוּם֙ אִתַּ֣ת אַבְרָ֔ם שָׂרָ֑י וְשׁוּם֙ אִתַּ֣ת נָחוֹר֙ מִלְכָּ֖ה בַּת֙ הָרָ֣ן אֲבוּהָ֔א דְּמִלְכָּ֖ה וַאֲבוּהָ֥א דְיִסְכָּֽה׃

Genesis 11:30 · ×2

וַתְּהִ֥י שָׂרַ֖י עֲקָרָ֑ה אֵ֥ין לָ֖הּ וָלָֽד׃
וַתְּהִ֥י שָׂרַ֖י עֲקָרָ֑ה אֵ֥ין לָ֖הּ וָלָֽד׃
וַהֲוָת֙ שָׂרַ֣י עֲקָרָ֔ה לֵ֥ית לָ֖הּ וְלָֽד׃

Genesis 11:31 · ×2

וַיִּקַּ֨ח תֶּ֜רַח אֶת־אַבְרָ֣ם בְּנֹ֗ו וְאֶת־לֹוט֙ בֶּן־הָרָ֣ן בֶּן־בְּנֹ֔ו וְאֵ֖ת שָׂרַ֣י כַּלָּתֹ֑ו אֵ֚שֶׁת אַבְרָ֣ם בְּנֹ֔ו וַיֵּצְא֣וּ אִתָּ֔ם מֵאֻ֖ור כַּשְׂדִּ֑ים לָלֶ֙כֶת֙ אַ֣רְצָה כְּנַ֔עַן וַיָּבֹ֖אוּ עַד־חָרָ֑ן וַיֵּ֖שְׁבוּ שָֽׁם׃
וַיִּקַּ֨ח תֶּ֜רַח אֶת־אַבְרָ֣ם בְּנֹ֗ו וְאֶת־לֹוט֙ בֶּן־הָרָ֣ן בֶּן־בְּנֹ֔ו וְאֵ֖ת שָׂרַ֣י כַּלָּתֹ֑ו אֵ֚שֶׁת אַבְרָ֣ם בְּנֹ֔ו וַיֵּצְא֣וּ אִתָּ֔ם מֵאֻ֖ור כַּשְׂדִּ֑ים לָלֶ֙כֶת֙ אַ֣רְצָה כְּנַ֔עַן וַיָּבֹ֖אוּ עַד־חָרָ֑ן וַיֵּ֖שְׁבוּ שָֽׁם׃
וּדְבַר֩ תֶּ֨רַח יָת֜ אַבְרָ֣ם בְּרֵ֗יהּ וְיָת֙ לוֹט֙ בַּ֣ר הָרָ֔ן בַּ֖ר בְּרֵ֑יהּ וְיָת֙ שָׂרַ֣י כַּלְּתֵ֔יהּ אִתַּ֖ת אַבְרָ֥ם בְּרֵ֖יהּ וּנְפָקוּ֩ עִמְּהוֹן֙ מֵאוּרָ֣א דְכַסְדָּאֵ֔י לְמֵיזַ֖ל לְאַרְעָ֣א דִכְנָ֑עַן וַאֲתוֹ֙ עַד֙ חָרָ֔ן וִיתִיבוּ֖ תַּמָּֽן׃

Genesis 11:32 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ֙ יְמֵי־תֶ֣רַח חָמֵ֤שׁ שָׁנִים֙ וּמָאתַ֣יִם שָׁנָ֔ה וַיָּ֖מָת תֶּ֑רַח בְּחָרָֽן׃
וַיִּהְיוּ֙ יְמֵי־תֶ֣רַח חָמֵ֤שׁ שָׁנִים֙ וּמָאתַ֣יִם שָׁנָ֔ה וַיָּ֖מָת תֶּ֑רַח בְּחָרָֽן׃
וַהֲווֹ֙ יוֹמֵ֣י תֶ֔רַח מָאתָ֥ן וַחֲמֵ֖שׁ שְׁנִ֑ין וּמִית֖ תֶּ֥רַח בְּחָרָֽן׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 11:1

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A linguist's distinction two millennia early: שפה is the language system — roots, conjugations, morphology — while דברים are the idioms and figures of speech that change from country to country and generation to generation without the language itself changing. He refutes Vitringa and Clericus (who read it as mere “one accord”) from 11:7: a confusion of counsel would not need a confusion of tongues.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 11:7

Grammatical polemic at its sharpest: ונבלה is not nifal (“their language will be confounded”) but first-person plural active — “we will confound.” The nun is the imperfect prefix, not the nifal marker; the verse's own ending proves it. Against all the grammarians, and he names the stakes: God's descent did not itself confound anything.

Em LaMikra · Gen 11:1

The pre-Babel memories — creation, the fall, the flood, one man saved with his three sons, a lofty God who rewards and punishes — survive in the traditions of all nations, old and new, as living testimony to the Torah's truth; everything after Babel reached the distant peoples only as garbled echo. Babel is his apologetic hinge: before it, one shared memory; after it, static.

HaKtav VeHaKabalah · Gen 11:5

“Descent” said of God is never locomotion — it is the turning of attention and will downward (ירידת העיון), when the Exalted One deigns to judge human deeds: punishment ordered for the good of the punished and to keep “the leprosy of wickedness” from spreading to others. Citing the Zohar, he makes וירד a doctrine of providence, not a journey.

Netinah LaGer · Gen 9:27

Onkelos did not change a thing in יפת אלקים ליפת because the Hebrew יפת is itself already Aramaic — from the root פתי, to widen (as he renders הרחיב ה׳ לנו in Genesis 26:22: ה׳ לנא אפתי). A loanword hiding in plain sight, and the Targum's fidelity is really etymology.

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 9:20

ושרי נח גבר פלח בארעא ויחל נח איש האדמה

Onkelos reads ויחל as שרי, “began” — pointedly not the midrashic חולין, “he profaned himself.” And איש האדמה becomes גבר פלח בארעא, a man who works the ground: the first farmer, not yet a fallen one.

Gen 9:24

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ואתער נח מחמריה וייקץ נח מיינו

יין becomes חמרא throughout Onkelos — the standard Aramaic word, but note the consistency: wine is never left as a Hebrew loanword in the Targum's world.

Gen 9:27

יפתי יי ליפת יפת אלקים ליפת

The famous midrashic etymology, smuggled into translation: יפת is read as יפה, “beautify” — “may the LORD beautify Japheth.” Not “enlarge” but grace: the nations' beauty housed, in the end, in Shem's tents.

Gen 9:27

וישרי שכינתיה במשכניה דשם וישכן באהלישם

Divine dwelling is never direct in Onkelos: וישכן becomes וישרי שכינתיה, “may He cause His Shekhinah to dwell” — the standard buffer between God and place, doing quiet theology in a single word.

Gen 10:9

גבר תקיף קדם יי גברציד לפני ה׳

Two moves at once: לפני ה׳, which sounds like Nimrod hunted in God's face, becomes the distancing קדם יי, “before the LORD”; and גבור ציד, “a mighty hunter,” is generalized to תקיף גבר, a mighty strongman — the hunt itself softened out.

Gen 10:25

פלג ארי ביומוהי אתפליגת ארעא פלג כי בימיו נפלגה הארץ

The etymologizing translation at full stretch: the name Peleg is nothing but the event — “for in his days the earth was divided” — and Onkelos keeps the Hebrew–Aramaic cognate pair (נפלגה / אתפליגת) so the wordplay survives the crossing.

Gen 11:5

ואתגלי יי לאתפרעא וירד ה׳ לראות

The double anti-anthropomorphism: God does not “go down” — He is אתגלי, revealed; and He does not come “to see” — He comes לאתפרעא, to exact punishment. Purpose replaces curiosity; the midrashic reading is the translation.

Gen 11:7

הבו נתגלי ונבלבל הבה נרדה ונבלה

Even divine first-person plural speech is buffered: נרדה, “let us go down,” becomes נתגלי, “let us be revealed.” The plural is kept — Onkelos will not flatten the verse's grammar — but the

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motion is translated into manifestation.

RASHI

Rashi on the week's two aliyot — all 62 comments

62 comments

Every Rashi comment on Genesis 9:18–11:32, printed in full: Noach's vineyard and the curse, the Table of Nations with its seventy names, Babel, and the ten generations from Shem to Terach. Read straight through, Rashi's two great modes alternate — the grammatical close-read and the midrashic deep-dive — sometimes within a single comment.

וחם הוא אבי כנען.

לָמָּה הֻצְרַךְ לוֹמַר כָּאן? לְפִי שֶׁהַפָּרָשָׁה עֲסוּקָה וּבָאָה בְּשִׁכְרוּתוֹ שֶׁל נֹחַ שֶׁקִּלְקֵל בָּהּ חָם וְעַל יָדוֹ נִתְקַלֵּל כְּנַעַן, וְעַדַיִן לֹא כָתַב תּוֹלְדוֹת חָם, וְלֹא יָדַעְנוּ שֶׁכְּנַעַן בְּנוֹ

וחם הוא אבי כנען *AND HAM IS THE FATHER OF CANAAN — Why is it necessary to mention this here?*

לְפִיכָךְ הֻצְרַךְ לוֹמַר כָּאן וְחָם הוּא אֲבִי כְנָעַן:

Because this section goes on to deal with the account of Noah's drunkenness when Ham sinned and through him Canaan was cursed.

Now as the generations of Ham have not yet been mentioned and we therefore would not know that Canaan was his son, it was necessary to state here that "Ham is the father of Canaan".

ויחל.

עָשָׂה עַצְמוֹ חֻלִּין, שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ לַעֲסֹק תְּחִלָּה בִּנְטִיעָה אַחֶרֶת (ב"ר):

ויחל *[AND NOAH] BEGAN — (The word may be connected also with a root meaning "profane") He profaned (degraded) himself, for he should have occupied himself first with planting something different (Genesis Rabbah 36:3).*

איש האדמה.

אֲדוֹנֵי הָאֲדָמָה כְּמוֹ אִישׁ נָעֳמִי (רות א'):

איש האדמה *A MAN OF THE GROUND — The master (owner, lord) of the ground;*

similar to Ruth 1:3 איש נעמי *"The husband (lord) of Naomi".*

ויטע כרם.

כְּשֶׁנִּכְנַס לַתֵּבָה הִכְנִיס עִמּוֹ זְמוֹרוֹת וְיִחוּרֵי תְאֵנִים (ב"ר):

ויטע כרם *AND HE PLANTED A VINEYARD — When he went into the Ark he had taken with him vine-branches and shoots of fig trees (Genesis Rabbah 36:3).*

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ויתגל.
לְשׁוֹן וַיִּתְפַּעֵל:

ויתגל *AND HE UNCOVERED HIMSELF — This is the Hithpael form.*

אהלה.
אהלה כְּתִיב, וְרָמֵז לִי' שְׁבָטִים שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ עַל שֵׁם שׁוֹמְרוֹן,

שֶׁנִּקְרֵאת אָהֳלָה שֶׁגָּלוּ עַל עִסְקֵי הַיַּיִן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַשֹּׁתִים בְּמִזְרְקֵי יַיִן (עמוס ו'):

אהלה *HIS TENT — This word is written* אהלה *(with* ה *at end instead of* ו*) so that it may be regarded as an allusion to the ten tribes who were spoken of as Samaria which was called "אהלה" Ohala and who were exiled because of indulgence in wine, at it is said (Amos 6:6) "that drink wine in bowls".*

וירא חם אבי כנען.
יֵשׁ מֵרַבּוֹתֵינוּ אוֹמְרִים כְּנַעַן רָאָה וְהִגִּיד לְאָבִיו,

לְכָךְ הֻזְכַּר עַל הַדָּבָר וְנִתְקַלֵּל (ב"ר):

וירא חם אבי כנען *AND HAM THE FATHER OF CANAAN SAW — Some of our Rabbis say that Canaan saw it and told his father about it, and on that account he is mentioned in connection with this matter and was cursed (Genesis Rabbah 36:7).*

וירא את ערות אביו.
יֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים סֵרְסוֹ וְיֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים רִבָּעוֹ (סנה' ע'):

וירא את ערות אביו *AND HE SAW HIS FATHER'S NAKEDNESS — Some say that he castrated him and some say that he sodomized him (Sanhedrin 70a).*

ויקח שם ויפת.
אֵין כְּתִיב וַיִּקְחוּ, אֶלָּא וַיִּקַּח לְמֵד עַל שֵׁם שֶׁנִּתְאַמֵּץ בַּמִּצְוָה יוֹתֵר מִיֶּפֶת, לְכָךְ זָכוּ בָּנָיו לְטַלִּית שֶׁל צִיצִית, וְיֶפֶת זָכָה לִקְבוּרָה לְבָנָיו,

ויקח שם ויפת *AND SHEM AND JAPHETH TOOK — (literally, "And Shem took and Japheth") It is not written here* ויקחו *"And they took", but* ויקח *"And he took", in order to teach regarding Shem that he devoted himself to this duty with more eagerness than Japheth.*

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אֶתֵּן לְגוֹג מְקוֹם שָׁם קֶבֶר (יחזקאל ל"ט),

Therefore have Shem's sons received the privilege of wearing the cloak that has fringes, and the sons of Japheth were privileged to receive honorable burial, as it is said, (Ezekiel 39:11) "I will give unto Gog (a descendant of Japheth) a place fit for burial [in Israel]".

וְחָם שֶׁבִּזָּה אֶת אָבִיו נֶאֱמַר בְּזַרְעוֹ כֵּן יְנַהֵג מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר אֶת שִׁבְי מִצְרַיִם וְאֶת גָּלוּת כּוּשׁ נְעָרִים וּזְקֵנִים עָרוֹם וְיָחֵף וַחֲשׂוּפֵי שֵׁת וְגוֹ' (ישעיהו כ'):

But as for Ham who despised his father — of his descendants it is said (Isaiah 20:4) "So shall the king of Assyria lead away the captives of Egypt, and the exiles of Ethiopia (these were peopled by the children of Ham) young and old, naked and barefoot and with buttocks uncovered etc." (Genesis Rabbah 36:6 and Tanchuma 1:2:15).

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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ופניהם אחורנית.

לָמָּה נֶאֱמַר פַּעַם שְׁנִיָּה? מְלַמֵּד שֶׁכְּשֶׁקֵּרְבוּ אֶצְלוֹ וְהֻצְרְכוּ לְהַפֵּךְ עַצְמָם לְכַסּוֹתוֹ הָפְכוּ פְּנֵיהֶם אֲחוֹרַנִּית:

ופניהם אחורנית *AND THEIR FACES WERE BACKWARD — Wherefore is it written a second time (that they turned themselves backward)?*

It is to tell us that when they came near to him and it was necessary for them to turn round in order to cover him they kept their faces turned away (Genesis Rabbah 36:6).

בנו הקטן.

הַפָּסוּל וְהַבָּזוּי, כְּמוֹ הִנֵּה קָטֹן נְתַתִּיךָ בַּגּוֹיִם בָּזוּי בָּאָדָם (ירמיה מ"ט):

בנו הקטן *HIS YOUNGER SON — The unworthy and despicable one, as (Jeremiah 49:15) "For, behold, I make thee small (קטן) among the nations, and despised among men" (Genesis Rabbah 36:7).*

ארור כנען.

אַתָּה גָּרַמְתָּ לִי שֶׁלֹּא אוֹלִיד בֵּן רְבִיעִי אַחֵר לְשַׁמְּשֵׁנִי,

ארור כנען *CURSED BE CANAAN — You have brought it about that I cannot beget a fourth son to serve me;*

אָרוּר בִּנְךָ רְבִיעִי לִהְיוֹת מְשַׁמֵּשׁ אֶת זַרְעָם שֶׁל אֵלּוּ הַגְּדוֹלִים,

cursed, therefore, be your fourth son (see Chap.

שֶׁהוּטַל עֲלֵיהֶם טֹרַח עֲבוֹדָתִי מֵעַתָּה. וּמָה רָאָה חָם שֶׁסֵּרְסוֹ?

10:6) to serve under the descendants of these elder ones upon whom the duty of serving me will devolve from now on.

אָמַר לָהֶם לְאֶחָיו אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן שְׁנֵי בָנִים הָיוּ לוֹ,

Why did Ham maltreat him in this manner?

וְהָרַג זֶה אֶת זֶה בִּשְׁבִיל יְרֻשַּׁת הָעוֹלָם,

He said to his brothers, "Adam Harishon had two sons and one killed the other in order that he might possess the whole world(Genesis Rabbah 36:7):

וְאָבִינוּ יֵשׁ לוֹ ג' בָּנִים וְעוֹדֶנּוּ מְבַקֵּשׁ בֵּן רְבִיעִי:

our father already has three sons, and he wishes to have yet another ".

ברוך ה' אלקי שם.

שֶׁעָתִיד לִשְׁמֹר הַבְטָחָתוֹ לְזַרְעוֹ, לָתֵת לָהֶם אֶת אֶרֶץ כְּנַעַן:

אלקי שם ברוך ה' *BLESSED BE THE ETERNAL, THE GOD OF SHEM, who will in days to come carry out his promise to his descendants to give them the land of Canaan.*

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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ויהי.
לָהֶם כְּנַעַן לְמַס עוֹבֵד׃

ויהי *AND MAY HE BE — Canaan — their servant serving and paying tribute (Cp.*

Josh.

16:10).

יפת אלקים ליפת.
מְתֻרְגָּם יַפְתִּי, יַרְחִיב׃

יפת אלקים ליפת *MAY GOD ENLARGE JAPHETH — The Targum renders the verb by* יפתי *meaning, "may He extend".*

וישכן באהלי שם.
יַשְׁרֶה שְׁכִינָתוֹ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל. וּמִדְרַשׁ חֲכָמִים אַע"פִּ שֶׁיַּפְתְּ אֱלֹקִים לְיֶפֶת שֶׁבָּנָה כּוֹרֶשׁ, שֶׁהָיָה מִבְּנֵי יֶפֶת, בַּיִת שֵׁנִי לֹא שָׁרְתָה בּוֹ שְׁכִינָה; וְהֵיכָן שָׁרְתָה?

וישכון באהלי שם *AND MAY HE DWELL IN THE TENTS OF SHEM — may He make His Divine Presence (Shechinah) dwell in Israel.*

According to the Midrashic exposition of the Sages (Yoma 10a) it means:

בְּמִקְדָּשׁ רִאשׁוֹן שֶׁבָּנָה שְׁלֹמֹה שֶׁהָיָה מִבְּנֵי שֵׁם׃

Although God enlarged Japheth inasmuch that Cyrus, who was a descendant of Japheth, built the second Temple, yet the Shechinah did not dwell in it.

Where, then, did it dwell?

In the first Temple which Solomon, a descendant of Shem, built.

ויהי כנען עבד למו.
אַף מִשֶּׁיִּגְלוּ בְנֵי שֵׁם יִמָּכְרוּ לָהֶם עֲבָדִים מִבְּנֵי כְּנַעַן׃

ויהי כנען עבד למו *AND MAY CANAAN BE SERVANT TO THEM — Even when the children of Shem be in exile, children of Canaan will be sold to them as slaves.*

ותירס.
זוֹ פָּרַס (ב"ר)׃

ותירס *AND TIRAS — This is Persia (Yoma 10a).*

להיות גבור.
לְהַמְרִיד כָּל הָעוֹלָם עַל הַקָּבָ"ה בַּעֲצַת דּוֹר הַפַּלָּגָה׃

להיות גבור *TO BE A MIGHTY ONE — Mighty in causing the whole world to rebel against the Holy One, blessed be He, by the plan he devised for the generation that witnessed the separation of the races (*דור הפלגה*) to build the Tower of Babel (Genesis Rabbah 23:7).*

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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גבר ציד.

צָד דַּעְתָּן שֶׁל בְּרִיּוֹת בְּפִיו, וּמַטְעָן לִמְרֹד בַּמָּקוֹם:

גבור ציד *A MIGHTY HUNTER — He ensnared the minds of people by his words, misleading them to rebel against the Omnipresent (Genesis Rabbah 37:2).*

לפני ה'.

מִתְכַּוֵּן לְהַקְנִיטוֹ עַל פָּנָיו:

לפני ה' *BEFORE THE LORD — intending purposely to provoke Him to His face*

על כן יאמר.

עַל כָּל אָדָם מַרְשִׁיעַ בְּעַזּוּת פָּנִים, יוֹדֵעַ רִבּוֹנוֹ וּמִתְכַּוֵּן לִמְרֹד בּוֹ, יֵאָמֵר זֶה כְּנִמְרֹד גִּבּוֹר צַיִד:

על כן יאמר *WHEREFORE IT IS SAID — Regarding any man who brazenly acts wickedly — knowing his Master and yet of set purpose rebelling against Him — it is said. "This man is like Nimrod a mighty hunter" (Sifra, Bechukotai, Section 2 1-2).*

מן הארץ וגו'.

כֵּיוָן שֶׁרָאָה אַשּׁוּר אֶת בָּנָיו שׁוֹמְעִין לְנִמְרוֹד וּמוֹרְדִין בַּמָּקוֹם לִבְנוֹת הַמִּגְדָּל יָצָא מִתּוֹכָם:

מן הארץ וגו' *OUT OF THAT LAND WENT FORTH ASSHUR — As soon as Asshur saw that his sons listened to Nimrod, rebelling against the Omnipresent by building the Tower, he went forth out of their midst (Genesis Rabbah 37:4).*

העיר הגדלה.

הִיא נִינְוֵה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְנִינְוֵה הָיְתָה עִיר גְּדוֹלָה לֵאלֹקִים (יונה ג'):

העיר הגדלה *THE GREAT CITY — This refers to Nineveh (not to Calah the last mentioned city nor to Resen), as it is said (Jonah 3:3) "Now Nineveh was an exceeding great city" (Yoma 10a).*

להבים.

שֶׁפְּנֵיהֶם דּוֹמִים לְלַהַב:

להבים *LEHABIM — So called because their faces were fiery as a flame.*

פתרסים ואת כסלחים אשר יצאו משם פלשתים.

מִשְּׁנֵיהֶם יָצְאוּ, שֶׁהָיוּ פַּתְרוּסִים וְכַסְלוּחִים מַחֲלִיפִין מִשְׁכַּב נְשׁוֹתֵיהֶם אֵלּוּ לְאֵלּוּ וְיָצְאוּ מֵהֶם פְּלִשְׁתִּים:

ואת פתרסים ואת כסלחים אשר יצאו משם פלשתים *AND PATHRUSIM AND CASLUHIM OUT OF WHOM CAME PHILISTIM — They (the Philistines) were descended from both of them for the Pathrusim and the Casluhim used to live together in promiscuous intercourse, and the Philistines were their offspring (Genesis Rabbah 37:5).*

ואחר נפוצו.

מֵאֵלֶּה נָפוֹצוּ מִשְׁפָּחוֹת הַרְבֵּה:

ואחר נפוצו *AND AFTERWARDS WERE SPREAD ABROAD — From these many families were spread abroad (besides those already mentioned.*

5:15—18).

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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גבול הכנעני.
סוֹף אַרְצוֹ. כָּל גְּבוּל לְשׁוֹן סוֹף וְקָצֶה:

גבול הכנעני *THE BOUNDARY OF THE CANAANITE means the end of his land:*

wherever גבול *occurs it signifies end and extremity.*

באכה.
שֵׁם דָּבָר. וְלִי נִרְאֶה כְּאָדָם הָאוֹמֵר לַחֲבֵרוֹ,

באכה *AS THOU COMEST - This word is a noun.*

גְּבוּל זֶה מַגִּיעַ עַד אֲשֶׁר תָּבֹא לִגְבוּל פְּלוֹנִי:

I think it is a colloquial expression like that used by a person who says to another:

This boundary stretches until you come to such and such a boundary.

ללשונותם בארצותם.
אַע"פִּ שֶׁנֶּחְלְקוּ לְלְשׁוֹנוֹת וַאֲרָצוֹת, כֻּלָּם בְּנֵי חָם הֵם:

ללשנתם בארצתם *AFTER THEIR TONGUES, IN THEIR LANDS — Although these were of different tongues and lands they are nevertheless all sons of Ham.*

אבי כל בני עבר.
הַנָּהָר הָיָה שֵׁם:

אבי כל בני עבר *THE FATHER OF ALL THE CHILDREN OF EBER — (*עבר *means the "side" or " other side" of a river) — The father of all the children of* עבר הנהר*, the other side of the River (Euphrates), was Shem.*

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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אחי יפת הגדול.

אֵינִי יוֹדֵעַ אִם יֶפֶת הַגָּדוֹל אִם שֵׁם, כְּשֶׁהוּא אוֹמֵר שֵׁם בֶּן מְאַת שָׁנָה וְגוֹ' שְׁנָתַיִם אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל, הֱוֵי אוֹמֵר יֶפֶת הַגָּדוֹל,

שֶׁהֲרֵי בֶּן ת"ק שָׁנָה הָיָה נֹחַ כְּשֶׁהִתְחִיל לְהוֹלִיד,

אחי יפת הגדול *[SHEM …] THE BROTHER OF JAPHETH, THE ELDER — (The Hebrew is ambiguous: "the elder" may refer either to Shem or to Japheth).*

וְהַמַּבּוּל הָיָה בִּשְׁנַת שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה,

One cannot from here determine whether Japheth was the elder or Shem.

נִמְצָא שֶׁהַגָּדוֹל בְּבָנָיו הָיָה בֶן מֵאָה שָׁנָה,

Since, however, it states (10:10) "Shem was a hundred years old … two years after the flood" you must admit that Japheth was the elder.

וְשֵׁם לֹא הִגִּיעַ לְמֵאָה עַד שְׁנָתַיִם אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל:

Because Noah was 500 years old when he first had children (5:32), and the Flood happened in the six hundredth year of his life (7:11), consequently the eldest of his sons was then one hundred years old, whereas Shem reached his hundredth year only two years after the Flood (and therefore Japheth was the elder of the two) (Genesis Rabbah 37:7).

אחי יפת.

וְלֹא אֲחִי חָם? שֶׁאֵלּוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם כִּבְּדוּ אֶת אֲבִיהֶם, וְזֶה בִּזָּהוּ:

אחי יפת *THE BROTHER OF JAPHETH — It does not state "brother of Ham", because those two honoured their father whereas Ham put him to shame.*

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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נפלגה.

נִתְבַּלְבְּלוּ הַלְּשׁוֹנוֹת וְנָפוֹצוּ מִן הַבִּקְעָה וְנִתְפַּלְּגוּ בְּכָל הָעוֹלָם. לְמַדְנוּ שֶׁהָיָה עֵבֶר נָבִיא, שֶׁקָּרָא שֵׁם בְּנוֹ עַל שֵׁם הֶעָתִיד;

נפלגה *[THE EARTH] WAS DIVIDED — The languages became confounded and they (the peoples) were scattered abroad from the plain of Shinar, and were dispersed throughout the whole world.*

וְשָׁנִינוּ בְּסֵדֶר עוֹלָם שֶׁבְּסוֹף יָמָיו נִתְפַּלְּגוּ, שֶׁאִ"תּ בִּתְחִלַּת יָמָיו,

We may learn from this that Eber was a prophet, for he gave his son the name פלג*, "division" after an event which was to happen in the future (Genesis Rabbah 37:7).*

הֲרֵי יָקְטָן אֲחִיו צָעִיר מִמֶּנּוּ וְהוֹלִיד כַּמָּה מִשְׁפָּחוֹת קֹדֶם לָכֵן,

For we learn in Seder Olam that it was during the last of his days that they were dispersed abroad.

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְיָקְטָן יָלַד וְגוֹ' וְאַחַר כָּךְ וַיְהִי כָל הָאָרֶץ וְגוֹ'; וְאִ"תּ בְּאֶמְצַע יָמָיו, לֹא בָא הַכָּתוּב לִסְתֹּם אֶלָּא לְפָרֵשׁ,

For if you argue that this happened early in his life (and that therefore he was not anticipating the future in so naming his son, but that the name referred to an event that had already happened), behold, his brother Joktan was younger than he and he had begotten many families previous to the dispersion, as it is said (10:26) "And Joktan begot etc." and only afterwards is it stated "And the whole earth was etc." (with reference to the dispersion).

הָא לְמַדְתָּ שֶׁבְּשְׁנַת מוֹת פֶּלֶג נִתְפַּלְּגוּ:

If, on the other hand, you argue that the dispersal happened in the middle period of his life, then I reply that the verse surely does not intend to refer to the time when the dispersion took place in an indefinite manner, but to state quite definitely when it was.

Hence you may learn that it was in the year of Peleg's death that they were dispersed.

ויקטן.

שֶׁהָיָה עָנָו וּמַקְטִין עַצְמוֹ, לְכָךְ זָכָה לְהַעֲמִיד כָּל הַמִּשְׁפָּחוֹת הַלָּלוּ:

יקטן *JOKTAN — He was so called ("the little one") because he was so humble and thought little* (ומקטין) *of himself;*

therefore he merited the privilege of rearing all these families (Genesis Rabbah 37:7).

חצרמות.

עַל שֵׁם מְקוֹמוֹ, דִּבְרֵי אַגָּדָה (ב"ר):

חצרמות *He was so called (Court of Death) after his city.*

So is the statement of the Agada (Genesis Rabbah 37:8).

שפה אחת.

לְשׁוֹן הַקֹּדֶשׁ:

שפה אחת *ONE LANGUAGE — The Holy Tongue (Hebrew) (Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 19).*

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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ודברים אחדים.

בָּאוּ בְעֵצָה אַחַת וְאָמְרוּ לֹא כָל הֵימֶנּוּ שֶׁיִּבֹּר לוֹ אֶת הָעֶלְיוֹנִים,

ודברים אחדים *AND ONE SPEECH — They came with one plan, saying: "He has no right to select the heavenly regions exclusively for Himself;*

let us ascend to the skies and make war upon Him".

Another explanation (of דברים אחדים *which is taken to mean "words referring to "One"):*

נַעֲלֶה לָרָקִיעַ וְנַעֲשֶׂה עִמּוֹ מִלְחָמָה. דְּבָר אַחֵר עַל יְחִידוּ שֶׁל עוֹלָם. דִּבֵּר אַחַר וּדְבָרִים אֲחָדִים

words regarding the Sole Being (God) in the Universe.

Another explanation of ודברים אחדים *is:*

they spoke דברים חדים *"sharp" words;*

אָמְרוּ אַחַת לְאֶלֶף ותרנ"ו שָׁנִים הָרָקִיעַ מִתְמוֹטֵט כְּשֵׁם שֶׁעָשָׂה בִּימֵי הַמַּבּוּל, בֹּאוּ וְנַעֲשֶׂה לוֹ סְמִיכוֹת (ב"ר):

they said, "Once in every one thousand six hundred and fifty six years (the period that elapsed from the Creation to the Flood) there is a heaven-shaking, just as there was in the days of the Flood.

Come.

then, and let us make supports for it" (Genesis Rabbah 38:6).

בנסעם מקדם.

שֶׁהָיוּ יוֹשְׁבִים שָׁם, כְּדִכְתִיב לְמַעְלָה וַיְהִי מוֹשָׁבָם וְגו' הַר הַקֶּדֶם וְנָסְעוּ מִשָּׁם לָתוּר לָהֶם מָקוֹם לְהַחֲזִיק אֶת כֻּלָּם וְלֹא מָצְאוּ אֶלָּא שִׁנְעָר:

בנסעם מקדם *AS THEY JOURNEYED FROM THE EAST where they were then dwelling, as it is written above, (Genesis 10:30) "And their dwelling place was ... the mountain of the East".*

From there they journeyed to search out for themselves a place that would accommodate them all, but they found none except Shinar (Genesis Rabbah 38:7).

איש אל רעהו.

אֻמָּה לְאֻמָּה, מִצְרַיִם לְכוּשׁ, וְכוּשׁ לְפוּט וּפוּט לִכְנַעַן:

איש אל רעהו *ONE TO ANOTHER — One nation to the other:*

Mizraim to Cush, Cush to Put.

and Put to Canaan (Genesis Rabbah 38:6).

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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הבה.

הַזְמִינוּ עַצְמְכֶם. כָּל הָבָה לְשׁוֹן הַזְמָנָה הוּא,

הבה *means, "Prepare yourselves".*

Wherever the word הבה *(come) occurs it has the meaning of "prepare", meaning that they should get themselves ready and unite for some work or plan or burden (undertaking). "Come, get ready":*

שֶׁמְּכִינִים עַצְמָן וּמִתְחַבְּרִים לְמְלָאכָה אוֹ לְעֵצָה אוֹ לְמַשָּׂא. הָבָה הַזְמִינוּ, אפר"לייר בלע"ז:

in old French appareiller;

English to prepare.

לבנים.

שֶׁאֵין אֲבָנִים בְּבָבֶל, שֶׁהִיא בִּקְעָה:

לבנים *BRICKS — For there is no stone in Babel which is a plain.*

ונשרפה לשרפה.

כָּךְ עוֹשִׂין הַלְּבֵנִים שֶׁקּוֹרִין טוויל"ש בל', שׂוֹרְפִים אוֹתָן בְּכִבְשָׁן:

ונשרפה לשרפה *AND BURN THEM THOROUGHLY — This is how bricks, which in old French are called Tuiles, English tiles, are made:*

they fire them in a furnace.

לחמר.

לָטוּחַ הַקִּיר:

לחמר *FOR MORTAR to plaster the walls.*

פן נפוץ.

שֶׁלֹּא יְבִיא עָלֵינוּ שׁוּם מַכָּה לְהָפִיצֵנוּ מִכָּאן:

פן נפוץ *LEST WE BE SCATTERED ABROAD — That He shall not be able by bringing some plague upon us, to scatter us from here.*

וירד ה' לראות.

לֹא הֻצְרַךְ לְכָךְ, אֶלָּא בָּא לְלַמֵּד לְדַיָּנִים שֶׁלֹּא יַרְשִׁיעוּ הַנִּדּוֹן עַד שֶׁיִּרְאוּ וְיָבִינוּ, מִדְרַשׁ רַבִּי תַּנְחוּמָא:

וירד ה' לראות *AND THE LORD CAME DOWN TO SEE — He really did not need to do this, but Scripture intends to teach the judges that they should not proclaim a defendant guilty before they have seen the case and thoroughly understand the matter in question.*

This is to be found in Midrash of R. Tanchuma.

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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בני האדם.

אֶלָּא בְּנֵי מִי? שֶׁמָּא בְּנֵי חֲמוֹרִים וּגְמַלִּים?

בני האדם *THE CHILDREN OF MAN (ADAM) — But whose children could they have been (except the children of man, i.e.*

אֶלָּא בְּנֵי אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁכָּפָה אֶת הַטּוֹבָה וְאָמַר הָאִשָּׁה אֲשֶׁר נָתַתָּ עִמָּדִי,

human beings) — perhaps the children of donkeys or camels?

אַף אֵלּוּ כָּפוּ בַּטּוֹבָה לִמְרֹד בְּמִי שֶׁהִשְׁפִּיעָם טוֹבָה, וּמִלְּטָם מִן הַמַּבּוּל:

But it means the children of Adam Harishon who proved himself ungrateful when he said, (Genesis 3:12) "The woman whom Thou gavest to be with me, [she gave me of the tree etc.]".

These people, also, were ungrateful, rebelling against the One who had showered kindness upon them and had rescued them from the Flood (Genesis Rabbah 38:9).

הן עם אחד.

כָּל טוֹבָה זוֹ יֵשׁ עִמָּהֶן, שֶׁעַם אֶחָד הֵם,

וְשָׂפָה אַחַת לְכֻלָּן וְדָבָר זֶה הֵחֵלּוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת:

הן עם אחד *BEHOLD, THEY ARE ONE PEOPLE — They possess all the advantage of being one people and of having one language common to all of them, and this is what they begin to do!*

החלם.

כְּמוֹ אָמְרָם, עֲשׂוֹתָם לְהַתְחִיל הֵם לַעֲשׂוֹת:

החלם *is infinitive, like* אמרם *"their speaking".* עשותם *"their doing" (i.e. "they speak", "they do") — so here: "they begin to do") (Genesis Rabbah 38:9).*

לא יבצר מהם וגו' לעשות.

בִּתְמִיהָה. יִבָּצֵר לְשׁוֹן מְנִיעָה, כְּתַרְגּוּמוֹ;

לעשות 'לא יבצר מהם וגו *This is a question (although the* ה *which introduces an interrogative sentence is absent):*

SHALL THEY NOT BE RESTRAINED FROM DOING WHAT THEY IMAGINE TO DO?

וְדוֹמֶה לוֹ יִבְצֹר רוּחַ נְגִידִים (תה' ע"ו):

The word יבצר *means "restraining", as the Targum understands it;*

a similar instance is, (Psalms 76:13) "He restrains (יבצור) the spirit of princes".

הבה נרדה.

בְּבֵית דִּינוֹ נִמְלַךְ מֵעֲנָוְתָנוּתוֹ יְתֵרָה:

הבה נרדה *COME, LET US GO DOWN — He took counsel with His Judicial Court because of His exceeding meekness (Sanhedrin 38b)*

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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הבה.

מִדָּה כְּנֶגֶד מִדָּה הֵם אָמְרוּ הָבָה נִבְנֶה,

הבה *COME — measure for measure:*

וְהוּא כְּנֶגְדָּם מָדַד וְאָמַר הָבָה נֵרְדָה׃

they had said "Come, let us build";

He meted out to them correspondingly saying. "Come let us go down" (Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 18)

ונבלה.

וּנְבַלְבֵּל; נו"ן מְשַׁמֶּשׁ בִּלְשׁוֹן רַבִּים, וְהֵ"א אַחֲרוֹנָה יְתֵרָה, כְּהֵ"א שֶׁל נֵרְדָה׃

ונבלה *means AND LET US CONFOUND The* נ *is the plural prefix, and the* ה *at the end is additional to the root as the* ה *in* ונרדה.

לא ישמעו.

זֶה שׁוֹאֵל לְבֵנָה וְזֶה מֵבִיא טִיט, וְזֶה עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וּפוֹצֵעַ אֶת מֹחוֹ׃

ולא ישמעו *— THEY MAY NOT UNDERSTAND — One asks for a brick and the other brings him lime:*

the former therefore attacks him and splits open his brains.

ויפץ ה' אתם משם.

בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה; מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ פֶּן נָפוּץ, נִתְקַיֵּם עֲלֵיהֶם,

ויפץ ה' אתם משם *SO THE LORD SCATTERED THEM ABROAD FROM THENCE—In this world (Sanhedrin 107b).*

What they had said.

הוּא שֶׁאָמַר שְׁלֹמֹה מְגוֹרַת רָשָׁע הִיא תְּבוֹאֶנּוּ (משלי י׳)׃

(Genesis 11:4) "lest we be scattered abroad" really happened to them.

This is what Solomon said, (Proverbs 10:24) "What the wicked fears will come upon him" (Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 18).

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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ומשם הפיצם.

לְמֵד שֶׁאֵין לָהֶם חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא; וְכִי אֵיזוֹ קָשָׁה,

ומשם הפיצם *AND FROM THENCE DID THE LORD SCATTER THEM —This teaches that they have no portion in the world to come (Sanhedrin 107b).*

שֶׁל דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל אוֹ שֶׁל דּוֹר הַפַּלָּגָה?

Which sin was greater:

אֵלּוּ לֹא פָשְׁטוּ יָד בָּעֵקֶר וְאֵלּוּ פָּשְׁטוּ יָד בָּעֵקֶר לְהִלָּחֵם בּוֹ,

that of the generation of the Flood or that of the generation of the Dispersion?

וְאֵלּוּ נִשְׁטְפוּ וְאֵלּוּ לֹא נֶאֱבְדוּ מִן הָעוֹלָם?

The former did not stretch forth their hands against God;

אֶלָּא שֶׁדּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל הָיוּ גַּזְלָנִים וְהָיְתָה מְרִיבָה בֵּינֵיהֶם, לְכָךְ נֶאֱבְדוּ;

the latter did stretch forth their hands against God to war against him (surely, then, the sin of the generation of the Dispersion was greater) and yet the former (the generation of the Flood) were drowned and these did not perish from the world!

וְאֵלּוּ הָיוּ נוֹהֲגִים אַהֲבָה וְרֵעוּת בֵּינֵיהֶם, שְׁנֶ' שִׂפָה אֶחָת וּדְבָרִים אֲחָדִים,

But the reason is that the generation of the Flood were violent robbers and there was strife among them, and therefore they were destroyed;

לְמַדְתְּ שֶׁשָּׂנְאוּי הַמַּחֲלֹקֶת וְגָדוֹל הַשָּׁלוֹם:

but these conducted themselves in love and friendship, as it is said, "They were one people and had one language". — You may learn from this how hateful to God is strife and how great is peace (Genesis Rabbah 38:6).

שם בן מאת שנה.

כְּשֶׁהוֹלִיד אֶת אַרְפַּכְשָׁד שְׁנָתַיִם אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל:

שם בן מאת שנה *SHEM WAS A HUNDRED YEARS OLD when he begat Arpachshad two years after the Flood.*

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על פני תרח אביו.

בְּחַיֵּי אָבִיו. וּמִדְרַשׁ אַגָּדָה אוֹמֵר שֶׁעַל יְדֵי אָבִיו מֵת;

על פני תרח אביו *IN THE PRESENCE OF HIS FATHER TERAH — meaning during his father's lifetime (Genesis Rabbah 38:13).*

The Midrashic explanation is that he died through his father.

שֶׁקִּבֵּל תֶּרַח עַל אַבְרָם בְּנוֹ לִפְנֵי נִמְרוֹד עַל שֶׁכִּתֵּת אֶת צְלָמָיו, וְהִשְׁלִיכוֹ לְכִבְשַׁן הָאֵשׁ,

For Terah accused his son Abram before Nimrod of having smashed his idols to pieces, and he cast him into a fiery furnace.

Haran waited and said to himself, "If Abram proves triumphant I will be on his side;

if Nimrod wins I shall be on his".

וְהָרָן יוֹשֵׁב וְאוֹמֵר בְּלִבּוֹ אִם אַבְרָם נוֹצֵחַ אֲנִי מִשֶּׁלּוֹ, וְאִם נִמְרוֹד נוֹצֵחַ אֲנִי מִשֶּׁלּוֹ; וּכְשֶׁנִּצַּל אַבְרָם, אָמְרוּ לוֹ לְהָרָן מִשֶּׁל מִי אַתָּה? אָמַר לָהֶם הָרָן מִשֶּׁל אַבְרָם אֲנִי, הִשְׁלִיכוּהוּ לְכִבְשַׁן הָאֵשׁ וְנִשְׂרַף, וְזֶהוּ אוּר כַּשְׂדִּים (ב"ר). וּמְנַחֵם פֵּרֵשׁ אוּר בְּקָעָה; וְכֵן בָּאֳרִים כַּבְּדוּ ה' (ישעיה כ"ד),

When Abram was saved they said to Haran, "Whose side are you on?" Haran replied, "I am on Abram's side".

They therefore cast him into the fiery furnace and he was burnt to death.

וְכֵן מְאוּרַת צְפָעוֹנִי (שם י"א) כָּל חֹר וּבֶקַע עָמֹק קְרוּי אוּר:

It is to this that the name of the place Ur-Kasdim (fire of the Chaldees) alludes (Genesis Rabbah 38:13).

Menachem ben Seruk, however, explains that אור *means a valley, as (Isaiah 24:15) "Glorify ye the Lord in the valleys (*באורים*)", and as (Isaiah 11:8) "the den (*מאורת*) of the basilisk".*

Every hole or deep cleft may be called אור.

יסכה.

זוֹ שָׂרָה, עַל שֵׁם שֶׁסּוֹכָה בְּרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ וְשֶׁהַכֹּל סוֹכִין בְּיָפְיָהּ; וְעוֹד יִסְכָּה לְשׁוֹן נְסִיכוּת, כְּמוֹ שָׂרָה לְשׁוֹן שְׂרָרָה:

יסכה *JISCAH — This was Sarah;*

she was also named Jiscah (from a root meaning ""to see", "to look") because she could see the future by holy inspiration, and because everybody looked (gazed) at her beauty (Megillah 14a).

*The name Jiscah also has reference to princely dignity (*נסיכות*) just as the name Sarah (*שרה*) has an allusion to "ruling"(*שררה*).*

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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Friday, 16 October 2026 · Aliyah 6+7/7 (Genesis 9:18–11:32) · Daf Bekhorot 28

ויצאו אתם.

וַיֵּצְאוּ תֶּרַח וְאַבְרָם עִם לוֹט וְשָׂרַי:

ויצאו אתם *AND THEY WENT FORTH WITH THEM* — ויצאו אתם *Terah and Abram went forth with Lot and Sarai.*

וימת תרח בחרן.

לְאַחַר שֶׁיָּצָא אַבְרָם מֵחָרָן וּבָא לְאֶרֶץ כְּנַעַן, וְהָיָה שָׁם יוֹתֵר מִשִּׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה;

שֶׁהֲרֵי כָּתוּב וְאַבְרָם בֶּן חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים וְשִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה בְּצֵאתוֹ מֵחָרָן וְתֶרַח בֶּן שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה כְּשֶׁנּוֹלַד אַבְרָם, הֲרֵי קמ"ה לְתֶרַח;

וימת תרח בחרן *AND TERAH DIED IN HARAN after Abram had left Haran (as related in the next chapter) and had come to the land of Canaan and had been there more than sixty years.*

כְּשֶׁיָּצָא אַבְרָם מֵחָרָן עֲדַיִן נִשְׁאֲרוּ מִשְּׁנוֹתָיו הָרְבֵּה,

For it is written, (Genesis 12:4) "And Abram was seventy five years old when he left Haran", and Terah was seventy years old when Abram was born (Genesis 11:26), making Terah 145 years old when Abram left Haran, so that there were then many years of his life left (i. e. he lived many years after that — as a matter of fact, 60 years, as he was 205 years old when he died).

וְלָמָּה הִקְדִּים הַכָּתוּב מִיתָתוֹ שֶׁל תֶּרַח לִיצִיאָתוֹ שֶׁל אַבְרָם?

Why, then, does Scripture mention the death of Terah before the departure of Abram?

שֶׁלֹּא יְהֵא הַדָּבָר מְפֻרְסָם לַכֹּל וְיֹאמְרוּ לֹא קִיֵּם אַבְרָם אֶת כִּבּוּד אָבִיו, שֶׁהִנִּיחוֹ זָקֵן וְהָלַךְ לוֹ, לְפִיכָךְ קְרָאוֹ הַכָּתוּב מֵת,

שֶׁהָרְשָׁעִים אַף בְּחַיֵּיהֶם קְרוּיִים מֵתִים,

In order that this matter (his leaving home during his father's lifetime) might not become known to all, lest people should say that Abram did not show a son's respect to his father, for he left him in his old age and went his way.

וְהַצַּדִּיקִים אַף בְּמִיתָתָן קְרוּיִים חַיִּים,

That is why Scripture speaks of him as dead (Genesis Rabbah 39:7).

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּבְנָיָהוּ בֶן יְהוֹיָדָע בֶּן אִישׁ חי (שְׁמוּאֵל ב' כ"ג):

For indeed the wicked even while alive are called dead and the righteous even when dead are called living, as it is said, (2 Samuel 23:20) "And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada the son of a living man".

(בחרן הַנּו"ן הֲפוּכָה לוֹמַר לְךָ, עַד

אַבְרָם חֲרוֹן אַף שֶׁל מָקוֹם):

בחרן *IN HARAN — The נ is inverted to tell you that until the time of Abraham, the fierce anger (חרון) of the Omnipotent was kindled against the world.*

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

m Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. N

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Two comments, two ways of borrowing

Genesis 9:22, וירא את ערות אביו: "יש אומרים סרסו ויש אומרים רבעו (סנה' ע')" — "some say he castrated him, and some say he sodomized him (Sanhedrin 70a)." This is unattributed compression. The Gemara stages a named dispute — Rav says castration, Shmuel says sodomy — and each brings a proof: the castration view argues Ham robbed Noach of a fourth son, so Noach cursed Ham's fourth son, Canaan; the sodomy view builds a gezerah shavah on וירא from Shechem in Genesis 34:2. Rashi keeps the dispute, drops the disputants, and drops both proofs. What survives is the shock — the reader must sit with the act, not the argument.

Genesis 9:22, וירא חם אבי כנען: "יש מרבותינו אומרים כנען ראה והגיד לאביו (ב"ר)" — the explicit peshat-to-aggadah pivot, flagged with its source. The verse's naming of Canaan here is redundant — his genealogy has not been given yet — so Rashi imports Bereshit Rabbah's reading: it was Canaan who saw and told his father, which is why he is named in the crime and cursed for it. Where the previous comment compresses the Talmud, this one cites the midrash by name and lets aggadah do the verse's structural work.

WORD STUDIES

Three words from the aliyot

Three words carry this week's double aliyah: שנה, the year that measures every lifespan; ויולד, the engine of the genealogies; בנים, the sons who become nations. (The Maagarim citation sweep could not be delivered this week — four browser lookups completed but their reports never arrived — so these studies draw on Klein, Jastrow, and BDB via Sefaria. Note: CAL, the Comprehensive Aramaic Lexicon at cal.huc.edu, prohibits scraping, so Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow/BDB via Sefaria.)

שָׁנָה

Klein · שנה

f.n.

— (dual שנתים, pl. שנים) year.

Jastrow · שינה

f.

— sleep. Ber. 3ᵇ מעולם לא עבר ... בש' midnight never found me asleep. Ib. 62ᵇ ש' בעמוד וכ' sleep at morning dawn (v. שינא I). Meg. 15ᵇ שנת וכ', v. נדד. Succ. 26ᵃ שינת, v. עראי. Ib. במוסר שינתו וכ' when he g

Jastrow · שנה

שנה (Klein: שנה, f.n., dual שנתים, pl. שנים — year) appears 24 times in the aliyah, and nearly every occurrence is a lifespan being weighed: "Shem was a hundred years old when he begot Arpachshad" (11:10), the formula tolling through ten generations to Terach. The year

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here is not a calendar unit but a biography — the Torah's way of saying a life had weight. The daf, fittingly, does its own year-arithmetic this week: thirty days counting as a year for the blemished firstborn (Deuteronomy 15:20). From lifespan-counting the word travels into the calendar — ראש השנה, שנה טובה — and lands in modern Hebrew as the plain word for year, its genealogical gravity mostly forgotten.

יוֹלֵד

Jastrow · יולד
Jastrow · יולד
m. pl.
— יולדים (b. h.; parents. Keth. VII, 6 המקללת יולדיו בפניו she who curses his (her husband's) parents in his presence; quot. ib. 72[b] יולידיו (an emphatic form), and interpreted במקללת יולידיו בפני מולידיו (v

BDB · ילד
— vb. bear, bring forth, beget (NH id.; Aramaic יליד, יליד, ; Arabic bear, bring forth, so Ethiopic Assyrian alâdu, COTGloss)—

ויולד, "and he begot" (17 times), is the hifil wayyiqtol of ילד that drives the entire Table of Nations and Shem's genealogy: "X lived Y years ויולד את Z." Jastrow's ילד covers bearing and begetting alike. The formula debuts in Genesis 5:3 — ויולד בדמותו, Adam begetting in his likeness — and our aliyah is its grandest performance, seventy names generated by one repeated verb. Chronicles will reuse the engine for its own genealogies. In modern Hebrew the root lands as הוליד, to father — and, in a semantic swerve the patriarchs could not have foreseen, to generate: software מוליד output. The begetting verb now begets data.

בֵּן

BDB · בן
— n.m. son (MI Ph. בן; so Sab. CISiv. No. 2, cf. בני DHMSem. Sprachforsch. 6; Arabic ; Assyrian bin(u), LyonSargon 9, 1. 57; especially in bin-bin, grandson COTGloss., cf. Dl infr.; Aramaic בר, , pl. בנין,

BDB · בן[2]
— n.pr.m. a Levite 1 Ch 15:18, but del. Be Öt cf. v 20.

BDB · בנו
— 1 Ch 24:26, 27 as n.pr.m. in AV RV, but render: the sons of Jaaziah his son, & the sons of Merari by Jaaziah his son, cf. VB & Be Öt.

בנים (BDB: בן, n.m., son — with cognates across Semitic: Arabic ibn, Akkadian binu) does double duty in the aliyah's ten occurrences. Literally it is "sons" — בני נח, the sons of Noah stepping from the ark (9:18). But in chapter 10 it becomes a political term: בני שם, בני חם, יפת בני are not boys but peoples, the Table of Nations' seventy clans. The journey from household to nationhood happens inside this one word — the same slide that will later make בני ישראל the nation's name. What the arc reveals for this aliyah: Genesis 10 is not a census but a charter, and בנים is the charter's signature — every nation introduced as somebody's son.

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